鹭鸶剪·玩法故事

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【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 01.1

COL-314101

The morning began with soothing silence,
起初，是令人心安的静谧。

punctuated only by a soft, cool breeze.
接着，有柔和、清凉的风。

And soon after, the first rays of sunlight broke through in full,
星星点点的阳光。

announcing the first gasp of spring.
——春日的清晨。

A young Daoist rests atop a leafy tree, feathered by the spring breeze and shaded by the leaves, slowly drifting toward sleep.
年轻道人躺在枝叶繁茂的树上。春风吹拂、树影摇曳，她几乎要如此沉沉睡去。

Paper Heron: Hm?
鹭鸶剪：……嗯?

Faint voices from below rouse her.
树下响起极轻的交谈声。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

She leans in to listen carefully.
道人细细辨认。

Paper Heron: Master? Finch?
鹭鸶剪：师父？师姐?

Though drowsy from her rest, she leans closer still, trying to make out what the voices are saying.
她懒洋洋地侧过身去，想要听得更清楚些——

Only to lose her balance and fall into endless darkness.
又一次，她坠入无边的黑暗。

Inn, Chun Town
淳镇·客栈小院

The sky above is a dull, pale gray. The first lunar month has just ended, and despite the melting of the ice and snow, the air feels colder than it should.
天色是萧瑟的青灰。才出正月，冰消雪融，温度反而降了不少。

The innkeeper slowly paces about the courtyard with her hands behind her back before deciding to rest in an empty chair.
掌柜在院中背手巡视一圈，捡了张无人的椅子坐下。

Innkeeper: It's freezing! Why hasn't that boy thrown more wood on the fire? Hm? Where is that lout, anyway?
客栈掌柜：这么冷的天，也不知道添柴……嗯？那小子人呢?

bang
“嘭!”

???: Didn't anyone teach you that there are rules out here?
???: ——外面的规矩，没人教过你吗?

???: I don't care about your rules. I follow my own principles!
???: 我不讲你的规矩，只讲我的道理！

Innkeeper: Is it too much to ask for a single day where no one draws their weapon in my inn?
客栈掌柜: 好端端地，又有人动刀动枪……

The innkeeper sighs and slips away from her barely warmed chair, moving deftly around the corridor to hide herself.
掌柜叹了口气，离开还没坐热的椅子，熟练地绕到回廊后躲了起来。

???: *cough* Madam ...
???: 咳咳，那个，东家……

Innkeeper: Ah! I was wondering where you'd gone off to. Avoiding your work, no doubt!
客栈掌柜: 好啊——我说怎么找不到你人，原来在这里偷懒呢。

Waiter: This is hardly my fault! Besides, it's not as though we have any real customers today.
伙计: 不能怪我啊！今天本来也没几桩生意……

Innkeeper: Shh, be quiet! They might hear you!
客栈掌柜: 嘘，小声些，你怕那边听不见啊?

Waiter: Alright, alright! I'll just take a quick look to see what's happening. Oh my, that man has a knife in his hand, but the girl he's facing actually looks calm, relaxed even.
伙计: 对对对，东家说得是。我瞟一下现在是个什么情况。哟，男的可提着刀呢！小姑娘倒斯斯文文……

Waiter: Wait, that peculiar mule of hers seems familiar.
伙计: 咦，她那头花里胡哨的骡子很眼熟啊……

clang
“锵——”

The innkeeper pulls the curious waiter back down and glares at him.
掌柜一把拉回探头探脑的伙计，瞪他一眼。

Innkeeper: What are you doing?! Are you trying to get the both of us killed?!
客栈掌柜: 看什么看，命不要了?

Innkeeper: *groan* Please don't break my elm tables and chairs. I only bought them this winter. Why must they start a fight just as we're closing for the night?
客栈掌柜: 唉，我这榆木桌椅可是冬天刚换的。都快打烊了，偏来这么一出……

A sudden yawn comes from a forgotten corner.
小院被遗忘的角落里，传来一声突兀的哈欠。

???: Closing time already?
???: ……店家，要打烊了吗?

The young Daoist in red lifts her head from her arms. A crease from her sleeve has left a faint mark on her cheek.
穿红衣的青年道人似是刚被吵醒，从臂弯中抬头，脸上还带着一道衣褶压出的印子。

She stands up and brushes off her clothes but looks reluctant to leave.
她茫然地站起来，拍拍衣摆，面露迟疑之色。

Daoist: But I haven't finished my mung bean cakes.
道人: 可我的绿豆糕还没吃完呢……

Innkeeper: Forget about the cakes. You'd better find somewhere to hide. There's going to be a fight!
客栈掌柜: 这位道长，先别管你那绿豆糕了，赶紧躲一躲。前边打起来啦！

Innkeeper: Should it get out of hand, some innocent bystander may get hurt. And that's the last thing I need on my conscience!
客栈掌柜：万一没刹住，伤着碰着可不是闹着玩的！

Daoist: A fight? Where? I don't see any—Oh!
道人：前边吗？我看看。

Daoist: Hmm.
道人：……唔。

Waiter: What are you—Why are you sitting back down?
伙计：哎哎，你怎么又坐下了？

Daoist: Because there's nothing to worry about. That girl knows her limits. She'll be careful.
道人：问题不大，小姑娘手底有分寸，不会伤人。

Waiter: What about the angry-looking man?
伙计：还有那凶神恶煞的男的呢！

Daoist: The man? Oh, he's certain to lose.
道人：他啊，他赢不了的。

Daoist: *yawn* So sleepy. This will take a while. Wake me when you close.
道人：呵……好困。这架还有得打呢……店家，等打烊了再叫我……

Innkeeper: What? This is no time for a nap!
客栈掌柜：道长，休息也看看时候吧！

The Daoist gives a casual wave of her hand, her head already resting on the table once more.
道人对掌柜随意挥了挥手，重新趴回桌上。

While the Daoist sleeps soundly, tensions run high near the gate.
院内的客人睡得正好，门口却剑拔弩张。

Girl with a Mule: Even if they don't aspire to be a hero, a Daoist should never use their skills to cheat people!
牵骡子的少女：我们修道之人，就算不想着行侠仗义，也不该滥用术法骗人钱财！

Man with a Knife: Ha! Who spoke any words of heroes?
持刀男子：——行个屁！

Man with a Knife: I won't let some irritating little bug lecture me! Come on, let's see what you're made of.
持刀男子：不长眼的东西，管到爷爷头上来了？我倒要看看你有几两本事！

Girl with a Mule: It takes no strength to know right from wrong, and this is a wrong I cannot walk away from!
牵骡子的少女：我也没多少本事，只是你做得不对，我既见了，就不能袖手旁观！

Man with a Knife: Big talk, little bug. Let's go!
持刀男子：好大口气，来！

Man with a Knife: Urgh!
持刀男子：……呃！

The man, pushed back a step into the courtyard, nearly topples before steadying himself.
男子被逼退一步，踏入小院，稳了稳身形。

Girl with a Mule: Bug's waiting. Come on!
牵骡子的少女：再来！

From his hiding spot, the waiter slaps a nearby wall in realization.
回廊后，伙计忽然一拍柱子。

Waiter: I remember her! She was involved in that trouble at the pawnshop last month.
伙计：我想起来了！就是她，上个月在对面当铺也闹过这么一回。

Waiter: Apparently, the pawnbroker Wáng was pressuring a customer to sell their family heirloom. That girl happened to pass by, so she intervened to try and reason with him. After exchanging only a few words, it escalated into a full-blown fight!
伙计：当时王大官人非要客人把家传的物件死当，她路过，上去替人讲理，三两句就动起手来，场面还不小！

Innkeeper: Oh, that girl! She showed up just before the Dushuo Festival, if I'm not mistaken.
客栈掌柜：——是她啊！小姑娘是不是年前就来镇上了？

Innkeeper: I heard she was looking for the, the, what was it again, Qi flows?
客栈掌柜：她到现在还没找到那个……那个什么，气脉？

Waiter: Whether she found it or not, she's certainly causing a world of trouble. Neither pawnbroker Wáng, talisman-seller Lǐ, nor the Head of the Armed Escort, Mr. Zhào, could stand against her.
伙计：这我哪知道？反正事是没少找。开当铺的王大官人、卖符箓的李天师、走镖的赵把头……都没在她手上讨到好。

The waiter counts out the names on his fingers, while the innkeeper shakes her head disapprovingly.
伙计掰着手指挨个数过去，掌柜摇了摇头。

Innkeeper: She's certainly bitten off more than she can chew this time.
客栈掌柜：唉，还是年轻啊……这下碰到硬点子了。

Innkeeper: ...
客栈掌柜：……

Innkeeper: Oh no, they're coming this way! Come, let's get out of here!
客栈掌柜：不好，他们冲这边过来了！快快快，咱们走！

Innkeeper: Um, you there, are you coming?
客栈掌柜：道长你走不走？

Daoist: Hmm.
道人：唔……

The sleeping Daoist only shifts place in response, clearly more interested in staying where she is.
睡梦中的道人只是换了个姿势。

As the fight draws closer, the innkeeper lets out a weary sigh, grabs her bumbling waiter by the collar, and rushes into the kitchen.
打斗声越来越近，掌柜长叹一声，猛地把还在愣神的伙计往后一拽，自己也跟着钻进后厨。

Man with a Knife: *sigh* So, you've got a few tricks up your sleeve after all. Not bad.
持刀男子：呼……有两下子……

Girl with a Mule: If you return the money you swindled and swear to clean up your act, I'll let you go!
牵骡子的少女：把骗来的钱财还回去，立誓不再作恶，我就放你一马！

Man with a Knife: Ha! And what makes you think I'll stay true to my word?
持刀男子：立誓有个屁用？

Man with a Knife: That money is long gone. And I wouldn't be so confident if I were you.
持刀男子：钱嘛，爷爷我早就花完了。你也别得意得太早……

With a glance at the napping Daoist, the man's sneer twists into a malicious grin. He flicks his wrist, sending his knife flying toward her.
男子瞥了一眼不远处趴在桌上小憩的红衣道人，忽地手腕一翻。

Girl with a Mule: Watch out!
牵骡子的少女：小心！

Gritting her teeth, she pivots and throws her longsword, sending it flying through the air and knocking the knife aside. She breathes a subtle sigh of relief.
她咬咬牙，抬手掷出横在身前的长剑，剑身破空而去，隔开刀锋。

clang
“锵。”

The longsword clatters to the ground, the sound almost lost in the man's bellowing laughter. With another sneer, he draws a second blade and brings it down in a heavy slash.
长剑落地。男子冷笑一声，挽了个刀花回转锋芒，沉重的一记向少女凌空劈下——

Daoist: Now that's a little much, don't you think?
道人：——这就过分了吧?

The blade stops mid-descent, its edge caught between a pair of fingers.
一只手止住了刀锋。

White Qi coats the Daoist's fingertips. She turns and smiles at the stunned girl.
道人指尖萦绕着莹白的剑气。她回头对还有些恍惚的少女笑了笑。

Daoist: Apologies for interrupting. I'm sure you can handle him yourself, but I just hate it when people don't play fair.
道人：其实你自己也能打得过他，我就是路见不平……

Daoist: I should've—No, my cake!
道人：——我的绿豆糕！

She swiftly brings her index and middle fingers together, tracing a sigil in the air. At once, the blade-knocked cake sails back onto the table.
她迅速并拢双指捏了个新诀，在空中一划，被刀锋震开的糕点便顺着手指的方向归拢回桌上。

Daoist: Phew! That was close.
道人：呼……还好还好。

Man with a Knife: A Daoist?
持刀男子：……哪来的道士?

The man looks her over and notices the white jade sword at her side.
男子狐疑地上下打量，看到她身侧的白玉长剑，不由冷笑一声。

Man with a Knife: So you had a powerful master waiting for me, did you?
持刀男子：好啊，还带着家伙……原来是找了高人在这里埋伏爷爷呢。

Daoist: Powerful master? Who? Where?
道人：高人？我吗?

Man with a Knife: You're nothing but a fraud! Despicable little bug!
持刀男子：小小年纪，如此卑鄙！

Girl with a Mule: I know nothing of her!
牵骡子的少女：我没有！

Daoist: Uh, I really only came for the cakes. Trouble showed up, so I stepped in. Nothing more, nothing less.
道人：我真是来吃绿豆糕的，路见不平而已，你怎么就不信呢?

Daoist: Now that you've stopped, perhaps we can talk this out like reasonable people.
道人：不过既然停手了，我们不妨有话好说……

The man lashes out with another strike, harmlessly cutting through the air above the Daoist's head.
又一道刀光闪过。

Daoist: *sigh* Not a talker, I see.
道人：唉。看来你是不打算有话好说了。

Daoist: With the flow of Qi, the mind opens wide!
道人：——贯炁明素，宸洞开微！

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 01.2

COL-314102

A red paper swallow flutters in the air, spins twice, then comes to rest on the tip of the man's knife.
红色的剪纸在空中飘飘悠悠转了两圈，忽地落下去。

Man with a Knife: Hmph. Is that all you've got?
持刀男子：哼，雕虫小技。

The paper swallow teeters on the spot.
燕子落在男子的佩刀上，打了个趔趄。

Daoist: Ahem! Sorry. Haven't done this for a while. Now!
道人：抱歉抱歉，我很久没和人动手了……着！

Man with a Knife: Wh-What's happening?!
持刀男子：……怎么回事?！

The man only stares, dumbfounded, as the swallow snatches the knife by the hilt and flies off with it toward the gate.
那燕子啄了啄刀柄，奋力拍拍翅膀，叼起佩刀向门外飞去。

Man with a Knife: My knife!
持刀男子：——我的刀！

Man with a Knife: You, you two ...
持刀男子：你……你们……

Man with a Knife: Hrgh! Fine. You and your master win this round, little bug. But don't let me see you in Chun Town again!
持刀男子：好啊，今日便算了，以后别让我在淳镇看到你！

Daoist: What a coincidence. I was planning on moving on anyway.
道人：别担心，我倒也没做久留的打算……

Daoist: Oh, he's gone. I wonder if he heard me.
道人：咦，他走得好快，不知听见没有?

The Daoist sits back with a yawn and a lazy shake of her head, her eyes turning to the girl's mule.
道人摇摇头，懒洋洋地坐下，对着骡子的方向歪了歪头。

Daoist: Your mule ... Perhaps you'd like to tie it up?
道人：你这骡子，不用拴起来吗?

Girl with a Mule: Huh? Oh, right!
牵骡子的少女：哦……哦，对！

Gathering herself, the girl affectionately pats the mule's ear and ties it to a pillar.
她恍然地应了一声，摸了摸骡子的耳朵，将它牵到廊柱边拴上。

Girl with a Mule: That was rather hairy. Thank you for dealing with that brute. My name is Pip, by the way. Would my rescuer be so kind as to give me hers?
牵骡子的少女：刚才真是好险，多谢前辈相助！在下阿措，还没请教前辈如何称呼？

Paper Heron: You're very welcome, Pip. They call me Paper Heron.
鹭鸶剪：不必客气，叫我鹭鸶剪就好。

Pip: Lady Paper Heron!
阿措：鹭鸶剪前辈……

Paper Heron: But just Heron will do.
鹭鸶剪：鹭鸶剪。

Pip: Alright, Heron.
阿措：好，鹭鸶剪。

Pip: So sorry to have disturbed your rest. Please, allow me to repay you with a meal.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，我打扰了你休息，该请你吃顿饭当作赔礼的。

Paper Heron: Oh, there's no need for that. I still have my cakes to work through.
鹭鸶剪：那倒不必，我还剩了半碟绿豆糕呢……

Pip: It would be remiss of me not to ... *gasp* Drop that right this instant!!
阿措：那便算……放下！！！

A sheet of snow slides down from the inn's eaves.
屋檐上的积雪簌簌落下。

Paper Heron turns her gaze toward Pip's outburst.
阿措的惊叫声中，鹭鸶剪顺着她的目光转过头去。

The mule, somehow freed, eyes her slowly. Then, with a deft flick of its tongue, it swipes the last cake.
不知何时挣脱了缰绳的骡子慢悠悠看她一眼，伸出舌头，将最后一块绿豆糕卷进嘴里。

Mule: Whinny?
骡子：咴?

Paper Heron: Did your mule just ...
鹭鸶剪：你……

Pip: I swear to you, I didn't tell him to do that!
阿措：我并未指使！

Paper Heron: Right, right. Not to worry.
鹭鸶剪：咳咳，别紧张。

Paper Heron: So, you said something about buying me a meal?
鹭鸶剪：我就问问，你刚才是不是说要请我吃饭?

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 02

COL-314103

White Horse School, ???
???·白马派

???: Heron?
???: 鹭鸶剪?

???: Heron!
???: ……鹭鸶剪!

Paper Heron: Finch? I thought you were due to be back tomorrow?
鹭鸶剪: 师姐? 你不是明天才回来吗?

Pearl Finch: So, what did you do with yourself while I was away?
师姐: 我不在的这几日，你又做了什么?

Paper Heron: The only thing there is to do: recite texts, morning and evening, over and over.
鹭鸶剪: 我在山上还能做什么? 不外乎早晚功课，依时诵经……

Pearl Finch: And Master sighing in the courtyard has nothing to do with you?
师姐: 我不是问这些。来时我看到师父在中庭不住叹气，难道跟你没关系?

Paper Heron: Well, he asked me a question, and I answered honestly.
鹭鸶剪: 咳咳……师父有事问我，我只是如实相告嘛。

Pearl Finch lets out a resigned, knowing sigh.
师姐叹了一口气。

Pearl Finch: "Answered honestly." And what might that answer have been, exactly?
师姐: 唉，如实相告。你是怎么如实相告的?

Paper Heron: Yesterday, before the morning class, Master went into his long lecture as always, and then asked each of us about our plans for the future.
鹭鸶剪: 昨日早课前，师父如往常一般教诲了大家好久好久，又突然挨个问我们往后有何打算。

Paper Heron: Brother Liǎng's aspirations are the same as always. He dreams of mastering the art of the blade, wants to carry the White Horse School's name far and wide.
鹭鸶剪: 二师兄的志向还是那样。他喜欢剑术，立志要苦练一番，把咱们白马派的剑发扬光大。

Paper Heron: You can guess what Master said to that, "Our school's sword is not a tool for violence."
鹭鸶剪: 你是知道师父的——“我派法剑，并非好勇斗狠的凶器!”

Paper Heron: Not a bad impression, eh?
鹭鸶剪: 喏，我学得像不像?

Pearl Finch: Well, you would know how to do it. You are the one who puts that look on his face most often.
师姐: ……自然，没人比你惹他发火的次数更多。

Paper Heron: Then Brother Sān stepped forward and said all who practice Daoism ought not to disrupt the natural flow of things but rather tend to their own minds—the very idea passed down from Ancestor Lǔ. You know the words: "When one's mind is tranquil and free of distracting thoughts, all things between heaven and earth will become one with it."
鹭鸶剪: 三师兄立刻站出来，说修道之人最要紧是无为，要修己心，自吕祖以来就是如此，所谓人能常清静，天地悉皆归嘛。

Paper Heron: Master got so angry he did that thing where he paced back and forth with his hands clasped behind his back.
鹭鸶剪：——气得师父背着手在原地转来转去。

Pearl Finch: Oh, what am I to do with you all?
师姐：唉，你们真是不教人省心。

Paper Heron: That's exactly what Master said!
鹭鸶剪：师姐，你真了解师父，他就是这么说的！

Paper Heron clears her throat and puts her hands behind her back.
鹭鸶剪清了清嗓子，两手背在背后。

Paper Heron: "Ahem. Your honesty is commendable. However, you have chosen narrow paths, ones lacking true vision or growth. Pearl Finch, your senior sister, however, possesses a more expansive vision. You would do well to look to her as your role model."
鹭鸶剪：“咳咳，你们愿意同我讲实话，这很好，但我辈中人，一己的修行毕竟是小道，短了些眼界。像你们师姐，心境就开阔得多，堪为我派的表率……”

Paper Heron: I was so happy for you, hearing such praise, that he caught me off guard when he suddenly asked me to share my own desires!
鹭鸶剪：师父夸了你许多，我正听得高兴，他却突然让我也说说！

Pearl Finch: You told him you want to go down the mountain and sell mung bean cakes, didn't you?
师姐：——于是你便告诉他，你打算下山去，卖绿豆糕？

Paper Heron: Yes, I ... Wait, how did you know that?
鹭鸶剪：咦，师姐已经知道了？

Pearl Finch: Brother Liǎng greeted me with the news before I even stepped through the gate.
师姐：唉。我还没进山门，二师弟就候着我告了你一状。

Paper Heron's stern senior finally smiles.
一直板着面孔的道人微微一笑。

Pearl Finch: If I recall, it was Taosu last time. Why the turn to mung bean cakes?
师姐：说来，你上回不是还想下山卖桃酥吗，怎么又成了绿豆糕？

Paper Heron: Well, Taosu are much too tricky to make. I'd never get the crust crisp enough. Mung bean cakes are far easier.
鹭鸶剪：后来我又深思熟虑一番，桃酥自然美味，但还得把控火候，实在费时费力……唉，我总做不出那样脆的酥皮。绿豆糕就容易多啦。

Pearl Finch: Clearly you've thought this through.
师姐：鹭鸶剪，你想得还真多啊……

Paper Heron: Of course I have. If spiritual development demands our full focus, then I say daily life does too.
鹭鸶剪：当然啦，既然在山上修行得全神贯注，山下的日子自然也应该如此。

Paper Heron: Master teaches that the Way is in everything. Brother Liǎng seeks it in the sword, Brother Sān in the mind. As for me, I'll look for it in my cakes. Perhaps we'll each find our way.
鹭鸶剪：不是说道蕴于万物吗，二师兄练剑，三师兄修他的心性，我卖绿豆糕，或许来日都能悟出些什么呢？

Pearl Finch: No wonder Master is upset. One fights, one studies, and one dreams of running a cake shop.
师姐：难怪师父气得不轻。练剑的练剑、吃书的吃书，还有你这个总想着做小买卖的。

Pearl Finch: The White Horse School has soldiers, scholars, and even wanderers. Yet none will answer its true calling. None will take up the duty of subduing Lǎnzhū.
师姐：白马派出得武举、秀才，连游手也有人选，偏就无人想着继承师门心法，接过镇压揽诸的重任。

Paper Heron: That's not true. We still have you.
鹭鸶剪：怎么没有？师姐你不就是嘛。

Pearl Finch: Me?
师姐：我……？

Paper Heron: We all know Master favors you. And you're the one who's been seeing to the school's affairs. It's only right that you inherit its legacy.
鹭鸶剪：对呀。师父是最喜欢你的，平日咱们白马派的事务也都是你在打理，师门的衣钵，自然也要你来继承。

Pearl Finch: Me? I ... I don't think so.
师姐：我……我是不成的。

Pearl Finch: Keeping Lǎnzhū subdued is our shared duty. A duty we all accept without hesitation. But, when the day is done, we each have different gifts.
师姐：看护揽诸……嗯，这是我辈中人的责任，我和你师兄们自然不会推辞。只是，各人禀赋终究不同……

She shakes her head and smiles, her shoulders dropping as she decides not to finish her thought.
她摇了摇头，微笑中多了几分怅然。

Pearl Finch: Never mind.
师姐：罢了，不说这些。

Pearl Finch: So, I brought some fresh Taosu from town. I'm not certain they'll be to your liking, but ...
师姐：我从山下带了新鲜桃酥，原本还担心你不喜欢。

Paper Heron's hand darts out, retrieving a Taosu with masterful precision. She takes a bite, and her expression melts with satisfaction.
一只手飞快地伸了过来。

Paper Heron: Heavens above! This is the taste! Hm, why do mine never taste like this?
鹭鸶剪：——就是这个味道！唉，我怎么做不出来?

Paper Heron: Well, this confirms things. For me, the Way does not lie in Taosu. It is only in mung bean cakes that I shall discover my path.
鹭鸶剪：看来桃酥中的大道已然于我无缘，不知绿豆糕中的大道又待如何……

Pearl Finch: Perhaps wait until you try some tomorrow before declaring your life's new mission.
师姐：绿豆糕中的大道，还是等你明天亲自尝了再说吧。

Paper Heron: Tomorrow? What's so important about ... Wait! Do you plan to take me down the mountain?!
鹭鸶剪：明天？师姐，你要带我去山下玩吗?!

Pearl Finch: Not for fun. We've got some business to attend to down there.
师姐：——是有事要下山去办。

Pearl Finch: And only if you promise me one thing. If Master asks you what you desire, please stop telling him you want to sell paper cuttings or snacks.
师姐：还有，以后别在师父面前说那些要卖窗花、卖吃食的话了。

Paper Heron: Alright, fine. I shall tell only you.
鹭鸶剪：好，那我只跟你说。不过，为什么呢?

Pearl Finch: He has high hopes for you.
师姐：他对你……向来有很深的期待。

Pearl Finch: It hurts him to hear you say it.
师姐：听了这样的话，难免会伤心的。

A ladle of hot oil splatters over the tofu, releasing the sharp aroma of spring onions and chili that hits the customers immediately.
一勺热油浇在豆腐上，葱花与辣椒的香气瞬时冲进鼻腔。

Pip: Ah-Ah-choo! This tofu ... Is it supposed to have this white fuzz?
阿措：啊——啊嚏！这豆腐上，是该有白毛的吗……

Waiter: Don't worry, miss. This is a Huanzhou specialty, hairy tofu. You won't find it anywhere else!
伙计：姑娘放心吧，离了涣州，别处还没有这毛豆腐呢！

Pip: Oh, wow! It tastes incredible. Heron, you must try ... try some ... Ah-choo!
阿措：尝着倒是不错。鹭鸶剪，你，你试试……啊——啊嚏！

Paper Heron: Hmm, it's alright. Not too different from the tofu I've had before.
鹭鸶剪：唔，和我从前吃过的那些豆腐，味道似乎没什么不同。

Pip: You don't like it? Let's get you something else.
阿措：你不喜欢吗？那我再叫些别的！

Paper Heron: Ah, don't you fret. I'm just being picky.
鹭鸶剪：没事没事，是我嘴笨，吃不出味道。

Pip: No, no. I promised you a good meal, so a good meal you'll get. Excuse me, may I have—
阿措：不行，说好要赔你一桌好筵席，就该作数。劳烦店家——

Innkeeper: You want more? But you've already ordered eight dishes.
客栈掌柜：可是姑娘，您都叫了八个菜了。

Pip: Oh, heh, would you look at that!
阿措：这……你说得也在理。

Pip glances at the full table and hesitates.
看着满满一桌碗碟，阿措有些迟疑。

Pip: It seems none of these dishes were to your liking, Heron.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，这些你似乎都不喜欢……

Pip: Will you still help me?
阿措：——那你还愿意帮我的忙吗?

Paper Heron can't help but laugh.
红衣道人忍不住笑了笑。

Paper Heron: You've been generous to me, despite my picky habits. It would be wrong of me not to.
鹭鸶剪：好吧，你都这么破费了，我怎么能让你失望?

Paper Heron: You mentioned something about Lǎnzhū, correct?
鹭鸶剪：你方才说，妖兽揽诸?

Pip: We're both Daoists, so you must know the story, the one about the Huanzhou immortal who sealed the beast away.
阿措：你我都是修道之人，你一定听说过涣州仙人镇抚妖兽的传闻吧?

Paper Heron: Yes, I know it. And you want my help dealing with this beast, eh? Hmm, that won't be an easy task.
鹭鸶剪：确实听过。你是想让我帮忙镇抚揽诸？唔，这可有些难办……

Pip is startled by her directness.
阿措吃了一惊。

Pip: Of course not! We don't have that kind of strength!
阿措：……我们哪有那样的神通?

Pip: What I wanted to ask was, are you familiar with Qi stagnation?
阿措：我只是想问，你知道何谓“气凝”吗?

Paper Heron: In a manner of speaking, yes. Though I'm not certain we're thinking of the same thing.
鹭鸶剪：唔，这我也知道，就是不晓得和你说的是不是一回事?

Pip: I've only heard my elders mention it. So, please correct me if I'm wrong.
阿措：我只听长辈提起过，如果说得不对，也劳烦你指正。

Paper Heron: Go ahead. Tell me what they said.
鹭鸶剪：无妨，你说。

Pip: The beast was subdued, but its influence on Huanzhou remains, causing some places to suffer from a stagnation in the flow of Qi.
阿措：揽诸虽被镇压，但余波仍在，涣州难免有些地方气脉凝滞。

Pip: I was told the danger varies. Sometimes it's little more than a tremor; sometimes it causes mountains to crumble or rivers to change their course.
阿措：气脉凝滞的危害……倒是可大可小，有时无甚紧要，有时却会致使山峦崩裂、河流改道。

Pip: But no matter the scale, it cannot be ignored. Left to fester, even minor stagnation can spiral into a catastrophe.
阿措：但无论大小，总不能任其发展下去，以免酿成大祸。

Paper Heron: Sounds about right to me. Though few possess this knowledge.
鹭鸶剪：不错，如今知道此事的人可不多了。

Pip: Mhmm. Those touched by the immortal's power are rare.
阿措：嗯，与仙人有缘者毕竟是少数。

Paper Heron: The immortal? Oh, you mean the Daoist who once subdued Lǎnzhū.
鹭鸶剪：仙人……？哦，你是说，镇抚揽诸的修道之人。

Pip: Yes. About two hundred years ago, one of my ancestors passed near Zhu County and was fortunate enough to receive guidance from that very same immortal.
阿措：正是。我家祖上两百年前游历祝县一代，有幸蒙受仙人指点。

Pip: Of course, we don't come close to their level of skill. But we can still discern a thing or two through the flow of Qi.
阿措：虽不抵其万一，但勉强也能窥见气脉中的关窍。

Paper Heron: Two hundred years. Has it really been that long?
鹭鸶剪：两百年……竟然过去那么久了。

Pip: They say, for an immortal, a century is but a moment.
阿措：或许对往来于天地之间的仙人而言，百年也不过弹指一瞬吧。

Pip: Anyway, while I was passing through, I noticed signs of stagnant Qi flow nearby, enough to tell me it could be serious.
阿措：总之，我游历至此，偶然发现附近气脉有凝滞之相，还颇为棘手……

Pip: Would you help me investigate them?
阿措：不知你愿不愿意帮我这个忙?

Pip: I swear, if you help me, I will come to your aid whenever you need it.
阿措：你帮了我，如果日后有用得到我的地方，我自然也义不容辞。

Pip: I don't know if I'll be of much use to someone like you, but I'll do whatever I can!
阿措：虽说你这么厉害，我也不知究竟能帮上什么……但总有机会的！

Paper Heron: Mmm. Alright.
鹭鸶剪：——好啊。

Pip: What? You've agreed? Just like that?
阿措：啊……？你这就答应了吗？

Paper Heron drums her fingers on the table.
鹭鸶剪敲了敲桌子。

Paper Heron: Well, you know what they say, "Destiny brings people together."
鹭鸶剪：是啊，相逢即是有缘嘛。

Paper Heron: And it seems, in our own ways, we're both bound to that immortal.
鹭鸶剪：何况，照你说的，我们还恰巧都与仙人有另一重缘法。

Paper Heron: A rarer touch of destiny than most encounter in their lives, wouldn't you say?
鹭鸶剪：——这可是比相逢更难得的缘分。

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 03

COL-314104

A cool evening spring breeze carries the scent of magnolia and the soft, damp breath of the river.
初春的晚风清凉，带着玉兰的香味，以及江水沉静的腥气。

As night falls, the bustling market street winds down, and a vendor, carrying two baskets of unsold magnolia flowers, slowly walks toward its end.
入夜后，长街上行人渐少。一名小贩挑着没卖完的两担玉兰花，慢悠悠往街那头走去。

Paper Heron leans on the windowsill, watching. She doesn't blink until the vendor disappears into the distant shadows.
鹭鸶剪趴在窗口向外望，眼睛一眨不眨，直到他消失在远处的阴影中。

Pearl Finch: What's on your mind?
师姐：在想什么？

Paper Heron: I was thinking every time I come down the mountain, there's so much that feels new.
鹭鸶剪：我在想……每次下山，总有好多新东西。

Paper Heron: Like that play *Receiving Longevity*! That was my first time seeing a floating stage on the water.
鹭鸶剪：就比如那出《受长生》！我还是第一次见水上的戏台。

Paper Heron: They were so far away. I could hardly see the person wielding the sword. But it must have been amazing. The cheers swelled like ocean waves.
鹭鸶剪：隔得那么远，不知道舞剑的究竟是谁，不过，想来很威风吧？所以才一阵一阵地有人叫好。

Paper Heron: And the lanterns on the boats! They lit up the whole river!
鹭鸶剪：船上的灯火，连江面都照亮了！

Pearl Finch: Hm. We've come just in time for the Dushuo Festival. It's my first time seeing it all too.
师姐：嗯。今年正巧赶上春社，我也是第一次见。

Paper Heron: They weave such beautiful lanterns! The bamboo splints they use are shaved so thin and woven together as finely as thread. And when they move, it's like watching carp swimming in a lotus pond.
鹭鸶剪：他们能扎那么漂亮的鱼龙灯！竹篾又细又密，就像用针线织在一起的。舞起来也好看，和莲池里的鲤鱼一模一样。

Pearl Finch: Brother Liǎng bought one once. Do you remember?
师姐：二师兄从前也买过，你不记得了？

Paper Heron: You're right, he did! But I like these lanterns more.
鹭鸶剪：当然记得，但还是这次的更让人移不开眼嘛。

Paper Heron: Though I'm not so sure about all the new food. Tofu with white fuzz, fish with strange flavors. Not to say they're bad, but ...
鹭鸶剪：新奇的吃食也多。豆腐上居然覆着白毛，鱼的味道也古怪……虽说不难吃……

Paper Heron: And the magnolia seller just now, we also saw one at the city gate this morning.
鹭鸶剪：还有方才的玉兰，我们今早在城门也见过有人叫卖的！

Pearl Finch: Magnolia flowers ... Yes. You can take some back, if you like.
师姐：玉兰花……对，我也问过你，是否要带些回去。

Paper Heron: Hmm, I would like some. But I'm worried they'll wilt before we make it back up the mountain.
鹭鸶剪：唔，我其实是想要一捧的！不过就算买了，等回到山里，花也早就谢了。

Paper Heron: It's better that someone else buys them. They'll last longer that way.
鹭鸶剪：还不如叫别人买走，还能多养些时间。

Waiter: Here you are, your tea.
小二：茶来了——

As they're talking, a waiter arrives with their tea and two plates of delicate pastries.
说话间，伙计将茶水送上来，又附了两碟精细的果子。

Tavern, ???
???·酒肆

Waiter: These pastries are a delicacy from the Wu region. I hope you enjoy them.
小二：吴地来的点心，甜甜蜜蜜——

Paper Heron: You have pastries from Wu?
鹭鸶剪：还有吴地的点心啊！

Waiter: Yes, indeed. We are the only establishment in all of Huanzhou that sells them.
小二：那是，整个涣州只有我家有，别处可吃不到。

Waiter: See that ferry out there? Delectable as they are, these pastries don't keep for long. They're best fresh from the boat. Were they to be sent to the next town, they'd lose their flavor before they ever arrived.
小二：看到外面的渡口没有？这点心不经放，一下船就吃还是好的，运到邻县就要变味啦。

Waiter: Huanzhou is all mountains, which makes travel difficult. But there is a ferry just east of our Chun Town. Thanks to that, we can use horses and boats to deliver these pastries here while they're still fresh.
小二：涣州多山，出入一向不方便，唯独我们淳镇东边有个渡口，好马快帆，才能赶上。

Waiter: Wu-style pastries are the finest, though they tend to be very sweet. I do hope they're to your liking.
小二：吴地点心最精细，就是太甜，不知道二位能不能吃得惯？

Paper Heron: Thank you. Now I have to try them!
鹭鸶剪：多谢。那我更要试试了！

She picks up the nearest one and examines it carefully.
她拈起一块绿色点心，细细端详。

Paper Heron: Master says I'm from Wu too, so what's so spec—
鹭鸶剪：听师父说，我也是吴地人，这有什……

Paper Heron: What in ... Bleh, it's sweet! It's filled with red bean paste!
鹭鸶剪：——这也太甜了，还是豆沙做的馅料！

Waiter: I did warn you. And before you ask, no. There are no refunds.
小二：小的可提醒过了，菜品一经售出，概不退换啊！

Pearl Finch shakes her head with a smile and pushes a cup of clear tea toward Paper Heron.
师姐摇头笑笑，推过一盏清茶。

Pearl Finch: Drink this. It will cut the sweetness.
师姐：快喝一口解解腻吧。

With this spring's tea leaves not yet ready, the establishment still serves last year's tea. Its leaves are aged, but the brew is light and clear.
今岁新芽尚未长成，茶仍旧是去年的陈茶，却也根根分明，茶汤有股极清淡的香味。

Paper Heron: This mung bean cake tastes nothing like the ones our brothers bought! By my eye, it seems they've used sticky rice and sesame oil. I wonder how they mix it all together.
鹭鸶剪：那绿豆糕吃起来和师兄们买给我的好不一样，我猜加了糯米和麻油！真不知是怎么调配的。

Paper Heron: If I were to sell them, I wouldn't use that rock-sugar bean paste. I'd go with something lighter.
鹭鸶剪：要是在涣州卖呢，或许该去掉冰糖豆沙的馅料，换上更清淡的……

Paper Heron: Hmm. But what's better? Maybe salt and pepper?
鹭鸶剪：嗯，不过用什么会好些？椒盐？……

...
……

...
……

Paper Heron: Finch? Are you still listening?
鹭鸶剪：——师姐？你还在听吗？

The wind picks up, bells chime gently under the buildings' eaves, and a pair of resting birds fly away, startled.
风变大了些，檐角下的铃铛叮叮当当地响起来。一对休憩的鸟儿被惊动，扑棱棱地飞走。

Pearl Finch: Heron, is it truly your desire to go down the mountain and sell cakes?
师姐：鹭鸶剪，你是真的想下山卖绿豆糕吗？

Paper Heron: Of course. But I can't just leave.
鹭鸶剪：当然想！不过，我总不能就这么走了呀。

Paper Heron: Just like our brothers. They don't really want to stay on the mountain either, do they?
鹭鸶剪：就像师兄们，也不是真的那么想待在山上吧？

Paper Heron: Brother Liǎng ... I've watched him practice with his sword. He's amazing! He wields his blade like the heroes in a story—the ones whose swords can cut water.
鹭鸶剪：二师兄……我见过他舞自己的剑，好威风！话本里侠客能截断秋水的剑也不过如此。

Pearl Finch: But our techniques focus on regulating Qi, concentration, and visualization. The Longevity Sword cares little for physical sharpness.
师姐：……但我派金丹术专修调气与存元，长生剑并不求这样一往无前的锋芒。

Paper Heron: True.
鹭鸶剪：对呀。

Paper Heron: And Brother Sān lives only for poetry and song. When I first came, he'd have his nose in a book of verses all day. All that knowledge, and he still couldn't remember the grandmaster's full title.
鹭鸶剪：三师兄更是只喜欢诗词歌赋。我刚入门时，他还成天捧着一卷诗钞翻来翻去，连祖师的尊号都记不明白。

Paper Heron: Convincing him to read Daoist texts for decades would be a real challenge.
鹭鸶剪：让他读上几十年的道藏，也当真为难。

Paper Heron: You've all been so kind to me—stayed with me. How could I possibly leave you behind?
鹭鸶剪：你们都还留在门中呢，又对我这么好，我当然不能自己离开！

Pearl Finch: Ah, you ... I can't even ...
师姐：唉，你们一个两个。

Pearl Finch: Do you have any idea how many dream of joining the White Horse School to learn the Method of Longevity? And yet, the three of you act as though it's nothing.
师姐：多少人想入白马派修习长生之法。在你们口中，这反倒成了一文不值的东西。

Paper Heron: But what's the difference between selling cakes and studying the Method?
鹭鸶剪：师姐，可是，卖绿豆糕与修长生术，又有什么区别呢?

Pearl Finch: There you go again.
师姐：……真是孩子话。

She lets out a long, weary sigh.
一声轻叹。

Pearl Finch: Of course there's a difference.
师姐：自然有区别。

Street, Chun Town
淳镇·长街

Half-melted snow leaves the ground slick with mud.
积雪堪堪融化了一半，正是最泥泞难行的时候。

At times like this, few are willing to brave the streets, save for a couple of tired-looking market stall vendors leaning against the roadside.
街上行人不算多，三两商贩靠在路边，神态惫懒。

Young Vendor: You know, I reckon we should head to the big fair in Zhu County next year. What's the point of staying in Chun Town?
年轻商贩：要我说，明年咱们也该去祝县的大集！留在淳镇有几个钱好赚?

Tired Vendor: *sigh* I'll think about it.
疲惫的商贩：唉，你让我再想想。

Young Vendor: What is there to think about? Look around, the town's empty! The only way to make money here is by depending on travelers or getting into some shady business. And the second is not an option for us.
年轻商贩：还想什么？睁眼看看，如今镇上人都快走光了！发财要么靠南来北往的行人，要么专捞偏门，咱们哪做得来?

Tired Vendor: I know, I know. But my family has lived in Chun Town for generations. Leaving isn't as easy as all that.
疲惫的商贩：我知道，我知道。只是祖祖辈辈都在淳镇，突然说要走，实在舍不得。

Young Vendor: Not like it's any different for me. But you know what they say, "A transplanted tree dies, but a relocated person thrives." You ...
年轻商贩：难道我不是吗？俗话说，树挪死人挪活，你……

Suddenly, the sound of hooves cuts through their conversation.
哒哒的蹄声打断了二人的争论。

Paper Heron: Excuse me, can you tell me how to get to the East Port?
鹭鸶剪：——劳驾，二位，东门渡怎么走?

Young Vendor: East Port?
年轻商贩：东门渡?

Tired Vendor: I can tell from your accent that you're not a local. If you're going to the Zhu County fair, then the port is the wrong direction.
疲惫的商贩：听口音，道长从外地来？若是往祝县看集，东门渡的方向可不对。

Paper Heron: That's quite alright. I'm not heading to Zhu County.
鹭鸶剪：无妨，小道不去祝县。

Tired Vendor: Forgive my asking, but why are you going there alone?
疲惫的商贩：那，我也得冒昧多问上一句，道长一个人去东门渡做什么?

Tired Vendor: That place is all but deserted.
疲惫的商贩：那地方可荒得很……

Paper Heron: Oh, I'm not traveling alone. I have a friend with me. She forgot the way, see, so I thought I'd come back to ask for directions.
鹭鸶剪：不必担心，我倒也有个同行的朋友。她一时忘了路，我脚程快，先折回镇上打听打听。

Young Vendor: Excuse my friend here, miss. What you do or where you travel is none of our business.
年轻商贩：哎，你管人家做什么？管好你自己吧！

Young Vendor: See the Paifang ahead? Go past it, head straight east, cross the woods to the river, then follow it downstream.
年轻商贩：道长，看到前边的牌坊了没？过了牌坊一直往东，穿过林子走到江边，再顺着水流的方向往下就是了。

Paper Heron: Thank you kindly.
鹭鸶剪：多谢多谢。

She bows and turns to leave but stops short, remembering something.
道人做了个揖，原本要转身离去，不知想起什么，忽地站住。

Paper Heron: One more thing: Does the East Port have a ferry?
鹭鸶剪：对了，东门渡……是个渡口吗?

Tired Vendor: It did, once upon a time. But it's been empty for a long while.
疲惫的商贩：确实是个渡口，不过早就荒废了，只是名字一直没变。

Paper Heron: I thought as much. I believe I've traveled on one there before.
鹭鸶剪：原来如此！我听着耳熟，似乎从前去过。

Tired Vendor: You must be joking.
疲惫的商贩：……道长莫不是在说笑?

Tired Vendor: Even in my grandfather's time, the ferries were deserted.
疲惫的商贩：我祖父那一辈，渡口就没什么人了……

Tired Vendor: When could you have possibly traveled on one?
疲惫的商贩：您却是何时去过啊?

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 04

COL-314105

Forest, Chun Town
淳镇·山林

The melting snow now lies thick, soaking last year's fallen leaves and branches.
去岁枯枝败叶叠了厚厚的一层，又被融化的雪水浸透。

Pip slogs ahead through the mud, pulling her mule behind her.
阿措牵着骡子，深一脚浅一脚地走在前面。

Pip: *pant* I thought the path would be easier once it warmed up.
阿措：呼……呼……我还以为天气转暖后会好走些……

Paper Heron: We can take a breath here if you like?
鹭鸶剪：就在这里歇歇吧?

Paper Heron takes the mule by the reins and ties it to a dead tree beside the path.
鹭鸶剪顺手牵过那头花里胡哨的骡子，将缰绳拴在路边的一棵枯树上。

Paper Heron: Is there a reason you don't ride your mule?
鹭鸶剪：你为何不骑着它走?

Hearing the question, the mule looks up at the Daoist, then drops its head and continues its search for seeds under the leaves.
似是听到有人叫它，骡子抬头看了道人一眼，又低头继续寻找枯叶下的草籽。

Pip: Because he isn't mine.
阿措：因为，这骡子不是我的。

Pip: The Qi stagnation we're seeking stems from somewhere near an old man's house near the East Port.
阿措：我们要去的气脉凝滞之处，就在东门渡一位老丈的居所旁。

Pip: I wasn't able to fully explain what Qi stagnation is to him. Still, he understood I wanted to help and insisted on giving me this mule.
阿措：气凝的事，我和他有些解释不明白……但他听闻我是来帮忙的，便非要以家中宝骡相赠。

Pip: But until I've finished what I came here to do, I can't accept his reward.
阿措：无功不受禄，事我还没办妥，自然不能拿人家的好处。

Pip affectionately pats the mule's back.
阿措在骡子背上拍了拍。

Mule: Whinny?
骡子：咴?

Paper Heron gives a nod of approval and gives the mule several pats of her own.
鹭鸶剪颇为赞赏地点了点头，也拍了拍骡子。

Paper Heron: You're right. It's the proper way to do things.
鹭鸶剪：你说得不错，正该如此。

Mule: Whinny!!
骡子：咴!!

Pip: Heron, you said you've been to the East Port before. When was that?
阿措：对了，鹭鸶剪，方才你说去过东门渡，那是什么时候的事?

Paper Heron: I don't recall exactly, but I know it was very many years ago.
鹭鸶剪：我想想啊……我记不清，但总归是很久很久之前了。

Pip: But you don't appear to be much older than I am.
阿措：可你瞧着并不比我大多少啊。

Paper Heron: And how do you know I haven't used a technique to preserve my youth, hm? Or that I draw power from moonlight? Apply storax ash to my face each night? Or drink a specially brewed tonic made with the purest water?
鹭鸶剪：这可说不好，世上有许多能让容颜永驻的术法。譬如采月华，苏合香灰敷面，或者服食无根之水煎制的汤药……

Pip: Really? Which one is it? What's your secret?
阿措：真的吗？鹭鸶剪，你用的是哪一种?

Paper Heron: Haha! None. You're so gullible. I can't help but wonder how your family allows you to travel alone.
鹭鸶剪：——哪一种都不是。你这么容易上当，家中长辈怎么放心让你独自在外游历?

Pip: *cough*
阿措：咳咳……

Pip: I think I've rested enough. Time to move. Maybe we can reach town before dark.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，我休息得差不多了。我们抓紧些，或许还能赶在天黑前回镇上……

Pip looks around, her gaze darting between unfamiliar landmarks.
阿措环顾四周，忽然有些犹疑。

Pip: I think I'm lost again.
阿措：只是，我好像……又找不到路了。

Pip: Through the woods to the east, right? Umm. Which way is east?
阿措：穿过树林往东去……东边是哪边?

Pip: Heron, is east to our left or right?
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你说东边是往左呢，还是往右?

An hour passes.
半个时辰后。

Pip: Ah, we're back where we started. Heron, you don't know the way either!
阿措：唉，又回来了。鹭鸶剪，原来你也不认路啊。

Paper Heron: Well, I always followed my seniors. I never had the need to learn how to find the way myself.
鹭鸶剪：没办法，我从前一向跟着师兄师姐们，哪用得着自己找路?

Paper Heron: But since we're looking for the Qi stagnation, perhaps I can come up with a different solution to help guide us.
鹭鸶剪：不过……既然是要去气凝之处，我倒还有个法子。

Paper Heron: Channel the power of the Way!
鹭鸶剪：——通幽洞微，默运虚无!

Paper Heron opens her palm and blows, her breath gently lifting a paper swallow to the breeze.
她摊开手心吹一口气，轻柔的风带着燕子飘浮起来。

It wobbles in the air for a moment before tilting its head back.
下一秒，它对鹭鸶剪歪了歪头。

Paper Heron: I left a trace of Qi on it. As long as we're not too far, it should be able to guide us to the stagnant Qi.
鹭鸶剪：我在它身上留了一道“气”，只要距离不太远，就能找到凝滞的气脉。

Paper Heron: My only hope is that we haven't wandered too far.
鹭鸶剪：唔，但愿我们没走太多岔路。

Pip: But ...
阿措：可是……

The swallow circles Paper Heron twice, then lands on her hair and begins pecking at its wing.
燕子绕着鹭鸶剪飞了两圈，从容落在她的发髻上，又低头啄了啄翅膀。

Paper Heron: Huh. It's never flown that fast before. Pip, did you see which way it went?
鹭鸶剪：奇怪，这回飞得好快。阿措，你瞧见它去哪里了吗?

Pip: Uhm. It seems to be on your head.
阿措：……它好像在你头上。

Paper Heron: On my head?
鹭鸶剪：我……我头上吗?

She pauses, then retrieves the paper swallow from her hair. Cupping it in her palm, she brings it up to her eye level.
她愣了愣，伸手一把摘下头顶的剪纸燕子，与它对视。

The swallow remains still, all previous signs of life absent.
燕子蹲在她的掌心，一动不动。

After a moment, Paper Heron sighs.
片刻后，鹭鸶剪叹了口气。

Paper Heron: Alright. I understand. It's no fault of yours. But we need you to find something else.
鹭鸶剪：好吧好吧，个么我晓得的呀……不是你的错，但我们是要你寻别的东西……

Whispering to the swallow in words Pip cannot understand, she swiftly sketches signs in the air with her index finger before clapping softly.
她对燕子轻声嘟囔着阿措听不懂的话，又伸出食指飞快画了几道符箓，双掌轻轻一拍。

Paper Heron: Go!
鹭鸶剪：去!

The swallow scans its surroundings, then flaps its wings and drifts toward the brush on the right.
燕子四处张望一阵，终于不情不愿地拍拍翅膀，慢慢悠悠往右手边的树丛飞去。

Paper Heron: There! Not a bad trick, eh?
鹭鸶剪：这下对了……厉害吧?

Forest Depths, Chun Town
淳镇·山林深处

Pip: *pant* This technique of yours ... Is it similar to what you did to that brute's knife back at the inn?
阿措：呼，呼……鹭鸶剪，你在客栈用的也是这招吗?

Paper Heron: Good eye. It's just a little trick I picked up. I can teach you if you like.
鹭鸶剪：差不多，小把戏而已。你要是想学，我可以教你。

Paper Heron: Come to think of it, we were so busy finding the way there that I failed to ask: why were you fighting that man in the first place?
鹭鸶剪：方才一直在找路，我都忘了问，你和那人是怎么打起来的?

Pip: He's a fraud, one that almost fooled me too!
阿措：他是个骗子，差点连我都骗了！

Pip: He had set up a fortune-teller's stall by the bridge. He claimed the land was cursed, blaming it for the town's decline, and offered to cleanse the misfortunes in exchange for offerings.
阿措：他在桥头支摊算卦，说淳镇地气不祥，所以才日渐萧条。只要乡民奉上香火，他就能作法请走煞气。

Pip: At first, I thought for certain he'd know more about Qi stagnation, so I wanted to ask for his advice. But after observing him for two days, I realized he was a fraud.
阿措：起初，我还以为他知道气脉凝滞的关窍，打算诚心请教……可仔细看了两日，才发现不过是个骗子。

Pip: He had enough skills to convince the villagers, sending dead leaves spinning in the air, making pebbles float. That sort of thing.
阿措：他确实会术法，表演了些让枯叶在空中随着手势打转、让石子凭空浮起之类的把戏，乡民看了，立刻信了七八分。

Pip: But when I confronted him, we'd hardly spoken a few words before he'd drawn his blade.
阿措：我和他对峙，还没说几句，他就拔了刀……

Paper Heron: I see. But before you fought, did it ever occur to you that you might lose?
鹭鸶剪：原来如此。那你动手前有没有考虑过，要是打不过他怎么办?

Pip: I wasn't about to stand back and let him swindle those poor people out of their money. Besides, you can only be sure of victory if you fight.
阿措：嗯……总不能由着他害人。打不打得赢，打了才知道。

Paper Heron: And what was your plan if you didn't win?
鹭鸶剪：如果打不过呢?

Pip: I figured someone like you would step in and put things to rights.
阿措：或许会有如你这样的人路见不平的。

Paper Heron: What if there wasn't anyone?
鹭鸶剪：要是也没有呢?

Paper Heron moves a dead branch out of Pip's path.
鹭鸶剪伸手为阿措拦开她未注意到的枯枝。

Pip: Thank you. If I'd failed, I'd have retreated.
阿措：多谢你。事若不济……我跑就是了。

Pip: There'd be no shame in losing. And when I'm older and stronger, I would return and win.
阿措：我年纪小，输了也不丢人。等以后本领高了，自然能打赢！

Pip: When I'm ... Well, when I'm around your age, I doubt I'll lose to anyone.
阿措：等我到了……对，等我到了你的年纪，大概就不会再输。

Paper Heron: My age? That's a lot further away than you might think.
鹭鸶剪：我的年纪吗？那还要过很久呢。

Paper Heron: I have to say, your strategy of retreating when you can't win is truly a Daoist act. Follow the heart and accept the natural way of things.
鹭鸶剪：不过，你这打不过就跑的想法，倒也可以算是从心所欲、道法自然了！

Pip walks a few steps ahead in silence, eventually speaking with her back still to Paper Heron.
阿措没有接话，沉默地走了一段，忽然背对着身后的鹭鸶剪开口。

Pip: That fraud spoke lies, but his words about the town failing? Those seem true.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，那骗子虽是胡言乱语……但他说镇上兴旺不起来，好像又没说错。

Pip: The old man who gave me this mule said Chun Town was once a bustling place. Now it's only lively during the big fair in Zhu County nearby.
阿措：送我骡子的老丈说，淳镇从前也是很繁华的……现在只有附近祝县大集的时候，这里才有几分人气。

Pip: Can stagnant Qi flow make a place, make so many lives, go wrong?
阿措：气脉凝滞，真的会让一个地方……让那么多人，都变得不顺遂吗?

Paper Heron: Maybe. "Plants die. Water turns foul. Animals leave." It all can happen. But we need to see for ourselves.
鹭鸶剪：唔，或许吧。草木凋敝，流水腐坏，鸟兽远徙……这些都是有可能的，具体如何，还是去看过才知道。

Paper Heron: Many things can change a town's fortune.
鹭鸶剪：毕竟能影响一处地方兴衰的东西可太多了。

Pip: Ever since I came down the mountain, I've tried to right wrongs—fight when I see injustice. I've even exposed a few cheats along the way.
阿措：我下山这些日子，看到不对的事就去管，碰到不平就去争，打赢了几场架，揭穿了几次骗局。

Pip: Pawnbroker Wáng forced low prices and exploited the townspeople. I argued with him.
阿措：开当铺的王大官人强压价钱、盘剥乡里，我与他理论过。

Pip: Tianshi Lǐ deceived his patients by selling incense ash as elixirs. I called him out.
阿措：李天师用香灰冒充丹药坑害病人，我拆穿了他的把戏。

Pip: And Zhào, Head of the Armed Escort, let his men bully the merchants. So, I fought him too.
阿措：走镖的赵把头纵容手下欺凌商户，我也和他动过手。

Pip: But ... But nothing seems to have changed.
阿措：可……可好像什么也没变。

Pip: Maybe I just don't know enough yet. If I were like you, or even better than you ...
阿措：但我觉得，只是我现在懂得还不够多。如果我像你一样，或者比你更厉害……

Paper Heron: That wouldn't change anything.
鹭鸶剪：——那也没办法。

Paper Heron: You have a good heart, Pip, and your mind is in the right place. But there are some things no one person can do.
鹭鸶剪：阿措，你想得很深嘛。但这世上确实许多事是谁也做不到的。

Paper Heron: Great skills can make a dead tree sprout and a flower bloom for a hundred years.
鹭鸶剪：高明的术法或许能让枯死的老树重发新芽，让花朵鲜妍百年长开不败……

Paper Heron: But no one can return to a spring that has already passed. All things flow as they will.
鹭鸶剪：但没人能回到已经过去的春天。世间万物有自己的流向。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron suddenly tilts her head, listening to something in the near distance. Then she smiles.
道人忽地侧耳细听，笑了笑。

Paper Heron: Forget it. Let's just focus on what's in front of us.
鹭鸶剪：算啦，还是先从眼下的事开始吧。

Paper Heron: Listen. Do you hear water?
鹭鸶剪：你有没有听到水声?

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 05

COL-314106

Apricot Tree, East Port
东门渡·杏花树下

Pip: Your paper swallow is amazing!
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你的剪纸燕子真好用！

Paper Heron: Is this really the East Port? It looks nothing like I remember.
鹭鸶剪：这便是东门渡吗？确实与我记忆中的不太一样……

Paper Heron: Hmm, it's quite different from the town too.
鹭鸶剪：嗯，与镇上也大不相同。

Frost still clings to the trees near the water, barring signs of life or greenery. Ahead, the river moves slowly, cutting its path through stretches of dry grass and sandbars.
岸边树木并无绿意，仍旧挂着寒霜。眺望前方，隐约能看见算不上湍急的江水穿过枯草环绕的江滩。

Near the door of a tall, worn house, an old man with white hair and a beard stares at one of the dead trees.
不远处高大而破旧的屋舍门口，须发皆白的老者望着枯树发呆。

Pip: I was just thinking the same thing. What do you ...
阿措：你果然也这么觉得！你说……

Suddenly, the mule lifts its head and brays. Then, without warning, it charges forward.
突然间，骡子仰起脖子长嘶一声，撒开四蹄向前方跑去。

Mule: Whinny!
骡子：咴！

Pip: Hey, you! Don't be so impatient!
阿措：你别急啊——

???: You're back? Didn't I tell you to accompany this nice young lady?
???：唉，唉，不是叫你跟着人家吗？

The mule stops beside the old man.
骡子在老者身边停下。

Pip: It seems more comfortable here with you.
阿措：老丈，既然它不愿意走，你就留下它吧。

Pip: I only want to do the right thing, sir. There's no need to give me anything in return.
阿措：我只是想帮上些忙，原不是为了报酬。

Elder: No, no. What would an old man like me do with a mule anyhow?
老丈：不成不成，老头这把年纪，也用不上它了。

Elder: You're a strong, good fellow, aren't you, boy? You'd be wasted with me, don't you think?
老丈：唉，你可是个有力气的好伙伴，跟着我可惜了，是不是？

Mule: Whinny!
骡子：咴！

Elder: I know, I know. I'll miss you too. But this is for the best.
老丈：我知道，我都知道。你不想走，但咱们没办法啊。

Elder: Once, many people passed through here. I made enough to feed you back then. But now, well, I'm sorry. I can't anymore.
老丈：前几年还有行脚的客人来，算是能过。如今……唉，我也养不了你了。

He gently strokes the mule's ear and sighs.
老者亲昵地伸手拨弄骡子的耳朵，又叹了口气。

Elder: Look at me, going on about a mule. What brings you back so soon?
老丈：你看我，光顾着说它的事。姑娘这么快就回来了？

Pip: You can rest assured, sir. Help has arrived. This is Paper Heron.
阿措：老丈，你放心，我请来了真正的高人——这位是鹭鸶剪前辈。

Pip: I may have lacked the skills to finish what I'd started, but I'm certain that she will be able to help!
阿措：之前是我学艺不精，她一定能为你排忧解难！

Paper Heron smiles at the old man and glances thoughtfully at the dead apricot tree nearby.
道人对老者笑笑，抬头望向不远处枯萎的杏花树，若有所思。

Paper Heron: Hmm. Seems we've come to the right place.
鹭鸶剪：唔……看来没找错地方。

Elder: Oh, don't trouble yourselves. The good days are long gone, and they're not coming back.
老丈：不必折腾了，姑娘。好日子过去了，哪还有回来的道理？

Elder: *sigh* Madam, I apologize for getting you involved in this nonsense.
老丈：唉，道长，也难为你被她拉着胡闹。

Pip: It is not nonsense!
阿措：这怎么是胡闹呢！

Elder: *sigh* There's a strong wind in the air. If you're to stay, please, come inside to talk.
老丈：外头风大，还请先到小老儿家中说话吧。

Old House, East Port
东门渡·旧宅

Elder: It's not much, but you're welcome here. Allow me to make you some tea.
老丈：家中简陋，没什么好招待的，我去煮些茶来，给你们吃。

Bright light streams through the window, making the time-worn carvings difficult to see.
依旧明亮的天光从窗外透进来，窗上雕花已经磨损得看不出原先的模样。

Inside, the furniture is fine but old, lending the room a solemn air.
屋内的家具陈设精致非常，只是都旧了，显得有些寂寥。

Pip: Alright, while he's making tea, let's speak frankly.
阿措：眼下老丈出去了，我们不必担心惊吓到他，就敞开了说吧。

Paper Heron: Frankly? About what exactly?
鹭鸶剪：敞开了说？你指什么？

Pip: Heron ...
阿措：鹭鸶剪。

Pip: The old man doesn't understand what's going on. How can he? But we both know this place is suffering from Qi stagnation.
阿措：老丈不明白其中关窍，可你我都是修行之人，该知道此处深受气脉凝滞之苦。

Pip: On the way here, did you notice anything unusual?
阿措：这一路走来，你有没有发现什么异常？

Paper Heron: Now that you mention it, yes. There were a few oddities on the road.
鹭鸶剪：如此说来，我今日遇到的异常倒有许多。

Pip: Such as?
阿措：……许多吗?

Paper Heron: Let's see: I got woken up by a fight, had my cakes stolen by a mule, and spent most of the trip wandering around lost. Quite the peculiar turn of events, wouldn't you say?
鹭鸶剪：睡觉时遇到人打架，被骡子偷吃了绿豆糕；行了十里，倒有八里在迷路……桩桩都是异常。

Pip: Not that kind of "unusual." I'm talking about the Qi flow!
阿措：我是说，与气脉相关的异常！

Paper Heron: Hmm. It is true that this was once a busy ferry crossing.
鹭鸶剪：非要说的话……我依稀记得，此地从前应有个繁华的渡口……

Elder: Oh my, few remember that old ferry now.
老丈：——如今还知晓这处旧渡口的人可不多了。

The old man hobbles over with a platter of coarse porcelain bowls filled to the brim with strong tea.
老者端来粗瓷碗，其中浓浓地沏了酽茶。

He sets them on the table, its lacquer worn and patchy but its surface clean.
他将茶碗放在桌上。桌面的漆色已磨得斑驳，却擦得干干净净。

Elder: This is a local blend. When the ferry thrived, even the people of Wu loved it!
老丈：道长尝尝本地的土茶。从前这渡口还在的时候，吴地的人喝了都喜欢！

Elder: It can't quite compare to the fancy teas folk prefer now. But it'll certainly quench your thirst.
老丈：虽说，如今也比不得外头时兴的茶叶了……但好歹能解解渴。

Paper Heron: This will do nicely, really. I'm not picky.
鹭鸶剪：没事没事，我不讲究这些。

Smiling, she takes a generous sip.
她抿了一口。

Paper Heron: Oh my, this tea is good! Better than most I've tried. Pip, you really must take a sip.
鹭鸶剪：这茶很好嘛！不比我在别处喝的差。阿措，你也尝尝?

Pip: Me? I ... I tried it last time.
阿措：我？我……我上回来的时候尝过了。

Pip holds her warm bowl in her hands, but her focus remains anywhere else.
年轻的修行者双手捧住微烫的茶碗，有些心不在焉。

She hesitates, then leans forward, looking at her companion across from her.
犹豫片刻，她身体微微前倾，专注地看着对面的道人。

Pip: I know you know more than you're letting on. Please just tell me the truth.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你既然已探查过四周，请实话告诉我——

Pip: Do you think Chun Town went downhill because there's something wrong with the Qi here?
阿措：淳镇如此萧条，究其缘由，是不是此地气脉出了大问题?

Outside the window, a dead leaf falls in silence.
窗外，一片枯叶无声落下。

Paper Heron: No.
鹭鸶剪：——没有。

Pip: No?
阿措：……没有吗……

Paper Heron: The Qi here is blocked, that much is certain. But you can't pin a whole town's bad luck on just that.
鹭鸶剪：嗯，气脉确实不畅。但要把一地兴衰都归咎于它……它倒也担不起这么大的罪过。

Paper Heron: As I said before, there could be many reasons for what's happening here. It could be the shifting of trade roads or simply a turning of the human heart.
鹭鸶剪：我不是说过吗？聚散离合、兴衰更迭，这里的缘由可能有许多。或许是商路改了道，或许是人心向了别处。

Paper Heron: In the end, everything has its season.
鹭鸶剪：月有阴晴圆缺，树有生发枯荣嘛。

Paper Heron: Not everything comes from magic and sorcery, nor can they be fixed by them.
鹭鸶剪：世间诸事，并不全因术法而起，也并不总能用术法挽回。

Elder: She's right.
老丈：姑娘，道长说得在理。

Elder: I don't understand Qi like the two of you seem to.
老丈：你说的那些……什么气脉，老头听不懂。

Elder: But the new trade routes that opened all go through Zhu County, so the ferry and town fell silent. That's just how things are.
老丈：可这些年有了新的商道，大家都愿意从祝县过，渡口连带着镇子，自然也就荒废了……这也是常情。

Elder: Please excuse her, madam. She's young, and her heart is in the right place. She believes everything must have a reason, a solution.
老丈：道长，您别介意。小姑娘年轻，也心善，总觉得什么都该有个道理、有个办法……

Pip: So it's not the Qi?
阿措：不是气脉的问题吗……

Paper Heron: I never said it wasn't. Stagnant Qi flows do pose a bit of a problem.
鹭鸶剪：——不过，眼前倒真有一桩麻烦，是那滞涩的气脉带来的。

Paper Heron pauses for a moment in thought before changing the topic of conversation to a more optimistic motif.
道人话锋一转。

Paper Heron: "Spring comes upon a withered tree." True, I cannot bring spring back. But making an old tree bloom again? That I can do.
鹭鸶剪：枯木逢春……我做不到把春天带回来，但如果只是让一棵老树重新开花，倒不太难。

Elder: What?!
老丈：这……?!

Elder: It used to be a local custom to plant trees here, back when the ferry still ran.
老丈：唉，当年淳镇的渡口还兴盛，乡里风俗，大家都在附近种树。

Elder: For those returning, the sight of our tree standing guard was how we knew we were home, even before the ferry docked.
老丈：离家的人惦念着家门前的树，还没靠岸，就知道到家了。

Elder: My family has lived by the ferry for generations. This apricot tree was planted by my ancestors. It's a reminder of home. Many generations have lived under its shade.
老丈：我家世代住在渡口边，这棵杏花树就是先祖归家的念想，几代人都在树下长大。

Elder: My grandfather stood under this tree when he sent my father off to work on the water. My father stood under it to see me push off for the first time. And every time we returned home, the tree was the first thing we saw.
老丈：我祖父在这树下送我爹去跑船；我父亲也在这树下，看着我第一次撑船离岸……每一次回来，船还没靠稳，最先出现的就是它。

Elder: And now the ferry is dead. Sometimes I think that the ferry, this tree, and I are all too old.
老丈：现在渡口荒了……我有时候想，我和渡口，还有这树，我们毕竟都老了……

Elder: If it could bloom again, that would grant this old man his dearest wish.
老丈：它若真能再开花，对我这老头子而言，便算了却一桩天大的心愿！

Paper Heron tilts her head in thought, a wry smile forming on her lips.
鹭鸶剪歪着头想了想，忽然笑了。

With a small flourish, she conjures a red paper-cut Mei blossom. It drifts down to settle on the worn table.
她掐了个手诀，一朵红色的剪纸梅花从她手中慢慢飘落到斑驳的桌面上。

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 06

COL-314107

Apricot Tree, ???
???·杏花树下

Boatman: Three, two, one. Good. Throw the line! Slowly now. Don't hit anything!
船夫：三、二、一，好，抛缆——前头慢些，别撞上了！

Deckhand: Where's the tea? I need a hand!
船工：茶呢？来人帮个手！

The last of the cargo is loaded, and the bustle at the ferry terminal fades into a murmur. Sunset dances an apricot tree's shadow on the water, while a white bird glides over its golden surface.
最后一批货也上了船，人声鼎沸的渡口渐渐安静下去。杏花树的倒影在夕阳下浮动，一只白鸟掠过金色的水面。

Paper Heron: This is the place with Qi stagnation? It seems normal to me.
鹭鸶剪：师姐，这就是气脉凝滞之处吗？看起来似乎没什么异常啊。

Paper Heron: I was expecting crumbled mountains and barren earth.
鹭鸶剪：我还以为会山峦崩摧、寸草不生呢……

Pearl Finch: No wonder Master's mad at you. You hear only what you want to hear.
师姐：难怪师父生你的气。他平日的话，你是不是只拣那些惊天动地的部分听？

Pearl Finch: What you're describing is the chaos of Qi when Lǎnzhū awakens. Qi stagnation is entirely different.
师姐：你说的是揽诸苏醒时气蕴紊乱的景象，但气脉凝滞并非如此。

Paper Heron: Ah, yes, that's right. I remember now!
鹭鸶剪：哦——我记起来啦！

Paper Heron: A place suffering Qi stagnation is effectively sealed shut. Nothing in it changes, grows, or dies. Right?
鹭鸶剪：是不是说，气脉凝滞的地方，一切都会被封存起来，从此不再变化——无法生长，也不会消亡？

Pearl Finch: Close, but not quite. To seal away Qi altogether would require a very powerful artifact.
师姐： 不尽然。如此彻底的封存，需得有极厉害的法器才行。

Paper Heron: Like Master's sword?
鹭鸶剪： 就像师父的法剑?

Pearl Finch: Oh, Heron, always drawn to the most peculiar things.
师姐： 你啊……怎么总对这些稀奇古怪的事格外上心?

Pearl Finch: More often, the life force in such places quietly fades away. You might not notice it at first, but over time, this decay becomes evident.
师姐： 更常见的情形是，气脉凝滞处的生机会悄然流逝。最初也许看不出，随着日月更迭，衰亡之象也会日益显现。

Paper Heron: That sounds serious.
鹭鸶剪： 听起来很是严重。

Pearl Finch: It could be major or minor. A mountain might collapse, or a small patch of grass might wither. No one can predict what will happen until the signs appear.
师姐： 可大可小。大则山峦倾覆，小则……或许只是一丛草木的枯荣。在迹象显现之前，谁也无法断言。

Paper Heron: So the whole town could suffer a serious disaster. Or just ...
鹭鸶剪： 也就是说，可能整个镇子都会遭殃，也可能只是……

She glances up at the apricot tree she leans against.
她抬头看向自己倚靠着的杏花树。

Paper Heron: This apricot tree here might not bloom again?
鹭鸶剪： 只是它未来不再开花?

Pearl Finch: Yes. Either way, we should act before any trouble arises. Better to be safe than sorry.
师姐： 嗯。无论如何，我们得防患于未然。

Pearl Finch: From what I can gather, there are traces of Lǎnzhū's last awakening still lingering here. The flow of Qi is still partially blocked.
师姐： 我方才探查过，此地仍受上次揽诸复苏的余波影响，气脉略有滞涩。

Pearl Finch: It's nothing too serious, but it's hard to rid it for good. It will need cleansing now and then.
师姐： 问题不算严重，只是难以根除，还须每隔一段时间加以疏导。

Paper Heron: Really? That's great!
鹭鸶剪： 那太好了!

Paper Heron: Ahem. I mean, good. Yes. I can help you whenever you come down the mountain.
鹭鸶剪： ——咳咳，我是说，太好了，往后我还能和师姐一道下山!

Paper Heron: Any thoughts on when you'll be coming down next?
鹭鸶剪： 不过，下一回要到什么时候呢?

The older Daoist looks at her, amused.
年长些的道人含笑瞥她一眼。

Pearl Finch: I'd say about two hundred years from now. Give or take a decade.
师姐： 约莫……两百年后吧。

Pearl Finch: By then, you'll be able to travel on your own. You won't need to follow me.
师姐： 在那之前，你已经能独自游历了，不必再跟着我。

Paper Heron: Two-Two hundred years?!
鹭鸶剪： 两、两百年?

Pearl Finch: Two hundred years ago, this was wild land, you know. No one lived here. Now it's a port with ferries and traders busying its waters.
师姐：两百年前，此地还是僻无人居的山野。两百年后的现在，还是同一个地方，津渡繁华，商贾船只来来往往，络绎不绝。

Pearl Finch: Who knows what it will be like in another two hundred years. The waters and fields will remain, but the sights will surely change.
师姐：等再过去两百年……不知这里会是什么模样？沧海桑田恐怕不易，但我们所见的风物，定然已与现在大不相同了。

A river breeze blows along the water's edge, knocking a few white and pink petals from their branches.
江风拂过，几片粉白花瓣零星落下。

Paper Heron catches one, holding it up to examine its dry, yellowed edge. Letting it fall to the ground, she turns her gaze to the treetop.
鹭鸶剪伸手抓住其中一片，拿到眼前。她盯着它已经微微蜷曲的、开始干枯发黄的边缘，又仰头看了看树梢。

Paper Heron: In two hundred years, this tree could grow to be as tall as the Mei tree at our school.
鹭鸶剪：两百年的时间，都能让这棵树长得像我们白马派的那株梅树一样高大了吧?

Pearl Finch: Perhaps, if it's lucky, if no axe cuts it down, if no disaster strikes.
师姐：或许。倘若它足够幸运，不遭刀斧，不遇天灾——

Pearl Finch: Or, in two hundred years, it could be forgotten.
师姐：否则，两百年也足以让它被人遗忘了。

Paper Heron: Hmm. I thought you'd be disappointed once you learned we're just saving one tree.
鹭鸶剪：唔。我还以为，知道只是救一棵树以后，你会失望呢。

Pip: I made a promise to the old man to help, and I will.
阿措：我既然答应了老丈帮忙，就一定要做到。

Pip: Besides, saving a tree is a good thing.
阿措：再说了，能救活一棵树也是很好的。

Pip: But where do we start?
阿措：只是……我们该从哪里开始?

The girl stares up at the long-barren tree, unsure of how to proceed.
少女仰头望着那棵许久没有开花的树，迟疑良久。

Pip: I did some investigating of my own. Clearing the Qi won't be the only difficulty. There's also an enchantment placed here by an immortal.
阿措：我也勘察过一二，难的并不仅仅是疏通气脉，也在于，此地有一处仙人设下的法阵。

Pip: I think this immortal saw the problem and placed the enchantment to clear the Qi. Clever, but over a hundred years have passed. The enchantment has decayed, letting the Qi stagnate once more.
阿措：我想，仙人应是经行此地发觉有异，便设阵疏导。百余年过去，这法阵难免日益磨损，故而气脉又渐渐凝滞。

Pip: How am I supposed to fix an immortal's work?
阿措：可这毕竟是仙人术法，我……我实在不知该如何补全。

Paper Heron: Not to worry. I know how.
鹭鸶剪：无妨，我知道。

Pip: You do?!
阿措：……你知道?!

Paper Heron: Intricate as this enchantment may be, it is no immortal's skill. Just a common ritual from my school. I've seen it many times since I was a youth.
鹭鸶剪：这不是仙人术法，只是我师门常用的法阵，我从小不知见过多少回。

Pip: Your school ... You didn't mention much about it on the way here. What's it like?
阿措：对了，你的师门……一路上你并未提过。那是什么样的地方?

Paper Heron: It's in Huanzhou. But we keep to ourselves up in the mountains, so you may not have heard of it.
鹭鸶剪：在涣州。不过我派门人甚少下山游历，你未必听说过。

Pip: Hmm. It sounds like a nice place to learn and grow your skills, away from the world.
阿措：嗯……听着像是不沾红尘、适合修行的好地方。

Paper Heron: Not exactly. My master once said that, in the old days, our seniors often descended the mountain. There's even a tale of a sage asking the head of our school for guidance. But that was long ago. No sect lasts forever.
鹭鸶剪：倒也不是。师父说，从前也有前辈在山下行走，据说连圣人也曾问道于掌教……只是此一时彼一时嘛，世上哪有长盛不衰的门派。

Paper Heron: As for the students ...
鹭鸶剪：至于门中弟子——

Pip: They must all be skilled cultivators of Qi. Like you.
阿措：想必都如你一般，是本领高妙的修行之人?

Paper Heron: Like me? Yes, and no. Each of us walked a different path.
鹭鸶剪：如我一般？也不是，大家各有志趣罢了。

Paper Heron: I was the last to join, see, and I'd always been a bit of a handful. Still, they all cared for me.
鹭鸶剪：我，你已经见到了。我入门最晚，性子又跳脱，很受大家照顾。

Paper Heron: Brother Liǎng was impatient and quick-tempered, always training the sword. He didn't quite fit the image of a master, more like a storybook villain. He ventured down the mountain more than anyone—loved meddling in other people's affairs.
鹭鸶剪：二师兄性子急，总是在练剑。他不大像高人，像话本里的恶人，对谁都看不起。他下山的次数最多，最爱管别人的闲事。

Paper Heron: Brother Sān hardly spoke, choosing only to read the Daoist texts over and over. He had the appearance of a master, but he loved to lecture and scold people. And when he did speak, his words were often so fancy that sometimes I think even he didn't know what he was talking about.
鹭鸶剪：三师兄不常说话，把道藏翻了一遍又一遍，瞧着倒有些像高人。不过他喜欢教训人，那些斥责的话文绉绉的，有时大家都听不太明白……

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron: I also had a senior sister at the school. We were the closest.
鹭鸶剪：我还有一个师姐，我们关系是最好的。

Paper Heron: She was kind. Master liked her. Whenever there was trouble, we went directly to her. And if Master was going to punish someone, we'd ask her to intervene.
鹭鸶剪：她性子好，得师父喜欢。平日有什么事，我们都找她帮忙；谁受了师父的罚，也总托她求情。

Paper Heron: But she didn't quite fit the image of a master either.
鹭鸶剪：她……但她也不像高人。

Paper Heron: The masters in tales are always ill-tempered, but not her.
鹭鸶剪：传说里的高人性子都不太好，和她不一样。

Paper Heron: She ...
鹭鸶剪：她……

Another river breeze ripples the face of the water, and several dead leaves float down from a bare branch.
江风拂过，几片残叶从枯枝上簌簌落下。

Pip: Heron?
阿措：鹭鸶剪?

Paper Heron seems totally lost in the branches of the apricot tree.
她出声提醒望着杏花树发呆的道人。

Paper Heron: Hmm? Oh. Sorry. I was lost in thought.
鹭鸶剪：嗯？哦，抱歉抱歉，方才在想别的事。

Paper Heron: Now, this enchantment. It's not one I've ever studied formally, but it's common enough knowledge in the school. It shouldn't prove too difficult.
鹭鸶剪：说回这阵法。我虽没专门学过，但门中几乎人人都会，想来也没什么难的。

Paper Heron: Here we go.
鹭鸶剪：你看好了——

Paper Heron puts two fingers together, takes in a shallow breath, and releases, white Qi swirling at her fingertips.
鹭鸶剪两指并在一处，一道莹白的气在她指尖盘旋。

Pip: Wow!
阿措：哇——

Paper Heron: With the flow of Qi, the mind opens wide!
鹭鸶剪：贯炁明素，宸洞开微！

She draws a complex sign in the air—one Pip has neither seen before nor understands—then points toward the tree.
她在空中划了道阿措看不明白的复杂符箓，又向杏花树的方向虚虚一指。

Paper Heron: Now!
鹭鸶剪：着！

A clear wind carrying withered grass sweeps over the treetops.
一阵裹挟着枯草的清风吹过树梢。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Pip: Is that it?
阿措：鹭鸶剪，这就结束了吗?

Pip: I know you said it wasn't difficult to fix, but I was hoping there'd be more of a show.
阿措：是了——你之前说过，此事并不棘手。如此，自然不会有什么风云变色的大场面。

Paper Heron: Ahem. Well, as you said, fixing it wasn't hard.
鹭鸶剪：咳咳……这个嘛。要解决起来确实不难……

Paper Heron lets out a slightly awkward cough.
她尴尬地轻咳了两声。

Paper Heron: But, despite my efforts, a problem still remains. Things are a little different from what I'd thought. I'll have to think of another solution.
鹭鸶剪：不过情况和之前的设想似乎……略有出入，我得想些别的办法。

Pip: A little different?
阿措：略有出入？

Paper Heron: Just a little! The enchantment is indeed from my school, yes. But the way to fix it ... Hmm. I'll have to think on that.
鹭鸶剪：只是略有！虽然此阵确是我派中人所设，加固它的方法……我还要斟酌斟酌。

Paper Heron: This enchantment is simple but elegant. To fix it, I'll need to guide the Qi using the same method employed when it was first cast.
鹭鸶剪：法阵本身并不复杂。但若要加固，须得用与布阵时一致的手法运转其中的“气”。

Paper Heron: But the enchantment is feeble. If I use too much power, I'll destroy it. One wrong move and it's gone.
鹭鸶剪：否则，施术者修为越深，对阵法的破坏反而越大。唔，这法阵已经很脆弱了，一不留神就可能彻底崩毁。

Paper Heron: I need to be very careful. Wait a moment.
鹭鸶剪：我们得慎之又慎……嗯？

Paper Heron pauses mid-cast. She moves closer to the tree and taps its trunk hesitantly.
她忽然停住，迟疑着在杏花树的枝干上轻叩两下。

Paper Heron: This enchantment feels familiar. It feels like my senior sister's work.
鹭鸶剪：这法阵运气的方式好生眼熟。这……似乎是我师姐设下的。

Pip: That's great! Then it should be easier to solve, right?
阿措：太好了！那，你现在是不是能解开它了？

Paper Heron: I'm not sure.
鹭鸶剪：……这是为什么？

Pip looks at Paper Heron, confused, but she doesn't look back. Instead, her gaze is fixed on the seemingly benign tree trunk, lost deep in thought.
阿措微微一愣，抬眼看向鹭鸶剪。后者也正望着她，两人对视，都有些茫然。

Pip: You said you often came down the mountain with your seniors. Perhaps you came here with your senior sister before?
阿措：我记得你说，你向来随师门一道下山，那这一次，会不会就是和你师姐一起来的？

Paper Heron: Perhaps that's so.
鹭鸶剪：……或许是吧。

Pip: From what you've said, it sounds like you were close.
阿措：听你刚才所言，你们感情颇深，你一定很了解她。

Paper Heron: Yes, we were.
鹭鸶剪：自然。

Pip: Well, since you know the caster so well, you must be familiar with her habits and style.
阿措：那……既然布阵之人与你如此亲近，你应当熟悉她施术的习惯与手法吧？

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron: I have little memory of what happened back then.
鹭鸶剪：当时的情境……我已经想不起来了。

Pip: Oh, I see.
阿措：唉，这样啊。

Pip taps her chin with her forefinger, thinking as she circles twice around the tree.
少女有些失落地思索着，绕着杏花树转了两圈，突然停下。

Pip: Oh! I have another idea.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，我还有个主意！

Pip: The ritual is your senior sister's, so the key is to mimic her style. Wouldn't the easiest way be to ask her?
阿措：既然此阵是你师姐所设，而破解之道又在于重现她的施术手法，我们何不请教她本人呢?

Pip: At first, I was stuck, so I came to you. But now you're unsure too. The only route left to follow is to find the original caster.
阿措：起初我束手无策，所以请来了你；如今你也没有十全把握，那找到最初布阵的人，就是最好的办法。

She speaks earnestly, growing more confident with each spoken word.
她认真地建议着，越说越觉得可行。

Pip: Yes! We'll likely be gone for a while, meaning we'll miss this spring's blossoming season. But as long as we resolve the Qi stagnation, we can come back next year.
阿措：对！我们得暂且离开几天，但这不成问题。哪怕错过今春的花期，只要解决了气凝之事，尚可以待来年……

Paper Heron: Finding her might be difficult.
鹭鸶剪：……恐怕有些困难。

Pip: Why? Is she traveling? In seclusion? It doesn't matter. You're from the same school. You must have a way to reach her.
阿措：她是在外云游，还是闭关修行？这都不打紧，你们既然是同门，总有联络的办法吧?

Paper Heron: A way to reach her ...
鹭鸶剪：联络的办法……

Paper Heron: It is possible, but I never learned how to summon a spirit.
鹭鸶剪：或许有吧。只是，我并未修习过招魂之术。

Pip: Wait, what? Summon a spirit?
阿措：嗯……嗯？招魂之术?

Pip: You mean she's no longer with us?
阿措：你，你是说，你师姐已经……不在人间?

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 07.1

COL-314108

Paper Heron: Is that it?
鹭鸶剪：——只需如此吗?

Paper Heron's senior sister sheaths her sword with practiced ease.
师姐将法剑插回鞘中。

Pearl Finch: Heron, stop staring. It's not a difficult spell.
师姐：鹭鸶剪，别看啦，这不是什么复杂的法术。

Paper Heron: But the way you wove the enchantment was impressive! Can you teach me?
鹭鸶剪：可是刚才结阵的法子好威风！师姐，能不能也教教我?

Pearl Finch: You haven't been with us long enough to understand our school's core teachings. Even if you learned the forms, they'd be little more than empty poses, and you'd be unable to cleanse the Qi.
师姐：你入门时间太短，尚未完全掌握我派心法，哪怕学了也空有架势，疏导不了凝滞的气脉。

Pearl Finch: With your natural talent, in ten years or so, you'll have built a solid enough foundation that weaving this enchantment will come easily.
师姐：再过十年吧。以你的天分，届时应已小有所成，学阵法定然会事半功倍。

Paper Heron: But what if I need to use it before then?
鹭鸶剪：万一在此之前，我有什么用得着这法子的地方呢?

Pearl Finch: If such a need arises, come find me, another senior student, or even Master himself.
师姐：叫我或者师父师兄们帮忙便是。

Paper Heron: And if I'm out alone and can't reach anyone?
鹭鸶剪：那，万一我独自在外行走呢?

Pearl Finch shakes her head and chuckles.
师姐摇头失笑。

Pearl Finch: You're just asking questions until I say "give it a try," aren't you? With so many new things to explore, one would think you'd be content enough as it is.
师姐：我看你是觉得新鲜有趣，才想试试吧？世上新鲜东西这么多，还不够你玩的?

Pearl Finch: Have patience, sister. Ten years is a short time. Follow Master's teachings, and I promise you, your time will come.
师姐：再等等吧。十年很短的，只消跟着师父做十轮正月的法事，也就到了。

Paper Heron: Ten years is a short time? That's over three thousand morning and evening classes. Over three thousand recitals of the *Scripture of the Big Dipper*.
鹭鸶剪：十年还短呀！要做三千余次早课晚课，念三千余遍《北斗经》呢！

Pearl Finch: *chuckles* Ah, Heron, so young, so impatient.
师姐：——我们鹭鸶剪毕竟还小呢。

Pearl Finch: Ten years may feel long now, but someday you'll look back and see it all as just a moment.
师姐：不过十年而已。你现在觉得漫长，往后回想起来，恐怕会觉得短如瞬息吧。

Paper Heron: Later, sure. But "later" isn't here yet! Right now, it's forever away.
鹭鸶剪：即便如此，那也是以后的事！眼下看来，这就是很长的时间啊。

Pearl Finch: ...
师姐：……

Pearl Finch: *sigh* Heron ...
师姐：唉，鹭鸶剪。

Pearl Finch: Master hasn't told you yet, but he intends to pass the two Longevity Swords to you.
师姐：师父还没来得及同你说，他打算日后把我派的两柄长生法剑传给你。

Pearl Finch: Longevity ...
师姐：长生……长生。

Pearl Finch: Do you know what longevity means? Truly means?
师姐：你知道何为长生吗?

Pearl Finch: Our school's practices already extend our lives to be longer than most. And you, with your natural talent and a mind so ready to grasp our core teachings, are a rarity.
师姐：我派众人修习内丹术，寿数原本就比常人要长上许多。而你……你天资那么好，难得心性又与我派心法相宜。

Pearl Finch: You must trust me when I say your "forever" will be longer than any of ours.
师姐：所以，你会有比我们所有人更漫长的时间。

Paper Heron: Only mine?
鹭鸶剪：……只有我吗?

Paper Heron: But what about the rest of you?
鹭鸶剪：那，你们呢?

Pip: Heron, are-are you alright?
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你，你还好吗?

Pip: It's my fault. I shouldn't have suggested ...
阿措：是我不对，不该提起你的伤心事。

Under the apricot tree, Paper Heron opens her eyes, the here and now slowly coming back into puzzling focus.
杏花树下，原本闭目凝神的鹭鸶剪略显困惑地睁开眼睛。

Paper Heron: Hmm? I'm fine. But you seem off.
鹭鸶剪：嗯？我很好，倒是你怎么了?

Paper Heron: You've been walking circles around me for a while.
鹭鸶剪：从刚才到现在，你都绕着我转了好几个圈了。

Pip: You haven't moved for some time, just stood there with your eyes closed. Did something remind you of your past?
阿措：你一动不动，是在睹物思人吗?

Paper Heron: I was thinking about the enchantment, and a memory surfaced. That's all.
鹭鸶剪：我确实在看这阵法，也确实在回想从前的事。

Paper Heron: I didn't mean to worry you.
鹭鸶剪：这便算是睹物思人吗?

Pip: Are you certain you're alright? You seem a little sad.
阿措：……我觉得，你好像有些伤心。

Paper Heron: Do I? I ... I was just trying to think of a way to solve our problem here.
鹭鸶剪：是吗？我……我只是在思考破解之法。

Paper Heron: I wanted to remember something from back then that could help us, but relying on my memory is, well, unreliable, at best.
鹭鸶剪：我原本想回忆当时的情境，无奈记性实在太差。

Paper Heron: But you're right. Things here remind me of "forever" ago.
鹭鸶剪：睹物思人……你说得对。

Paper Heron: I should think about what kind of person Finch ...
鹭鸶剪：我该想想，师姐是怎样的人……

Paper Heron: No, I don't think that would help. I should focus on how she set the enchantment back then.
鹭鸶剪：不，我该感受感受，她当年是如何布下法阵的……

Paper Heron places her palm on the dry trunk and closes her eyes once more.
道人将手掌轻轻放在干枯的树干上，重新闭上眼睛。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Some things in this world follow the great cycle of the Way, like the turning of the seasons, the gifts of nature, the rise and fall of a town.
世上有些事如大道周行，譬如四季轮回、天分禀赋，以及城镇的兴衰。

Other things hold the vastness of the world within their minute form, like the color of apricot flowers, a spring breeze, and a simple spell cast by a hand gesture.
也有另一些事，是须弥芥子。譬如杏花的颜色。春风。简单的手诀。

Like holding a familiar hand.
譬如，握一只熟悉的手。

Paper Heron: I ...
鹭鸶剪：我……

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron: I've found her.
鹭鸶剪：——找到了。

A slight gasp escapes Paper Heron's lip as she reaches within herself to hold that hand.
——她握住了那只手。

Paper Heron: She always wielded arcane techniques with more precision than others.
鹭鸶剪：同样的术法，她用得总比旁人更精准。

Her natural talent was nothing special; she had to rely on arcane techniques.
——她的天资并不算高，只能求诸于术。

Paper Heron: She left space for future adjustments to the Qi. I can feel it, hidden in plain sight.
鹭鸶剪：引导气脉时，她习惯留一个口子，以便修正。

She was the most reliable one, so she was entrusted with managing the school's affairs.

——她思虑最周全，所以才能打理白马派上下事务。

Paper Heron: She was also skilled in sensing the flow of Qi.
鹭鸶剪：她……也擅长体察气的流动。

A peer of the most observant, most caring kind.
——她最心细，最关心周围的一切。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron: Finch.
鹭鸶剪：师姐。

Paper Heron: I want to remember more about you.
鹭鸶剪：再让我多想起一些吧。

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 07.2

COL-314109

Pip stares at a patch of dead grass by her feet, lost in thought.
阿措已经低头盯着脚下一小块枯草发了许久的呆。

The mule approaches and nibbles at the roots. She strokes its ear, her mind elsewhere.
直到骡子慢悠悠地踱过来啃食草根，她才心不在焉地摸了摸它的耳朵。

Pip: You also think she seems sad, don't you?
阿措：你也觉得她看着有些伤心吧?

Mule: Bray.
骡子：——咴。

Pip: *sigh* It's all my fault.
阿措：唉，都是我不对。

Pip: When we go back, I'll apologize properly to the elder. It's the least I can do, right?
阿措：等我们回去，我向老丈赔个不是，好不好?

Pip: In the worst case, we figure another method out somewhere else.
阿措：大不了，再到别处想想办法……

Pip: ...
阿措：……

A petal falls on the withered grass.
一片花瓣落在枯草上。

Pip: Hmm?
阿措：嗯……?

As Pip looks up, her eyes widen in disbelief.
她抬头望去，眼前是不可思议的一幕——

The sea of dead grass shifts from gray-yellow to tender green, and in the center, the dying apricot tree bursts into life.
荒草正在由灰黄转为嫩绿。而就在草丛正中，那株垂死的杏树骤然焕发生机。

Great clusters of apricot blossoms weigh down the branches, like a waterfall of flowers.
大片大片的杏花叠满枝头，盛放着压坠枝梢，如一道灿烂的花瀑。

Petals, light and thin, drift on the gentle breeze like soft snow, vanishing the instant they land.
一阵江风吹来，又轻又薄的花瓣纷纷扬扬落下，像最轻柔的雪花，沾上衣襟便会融化。

Pip cradles a petal in the palm of her hand. It feels alive, moist, and full.
阿措伸手接住一瓣。花瓣生机勃勃，带着微卷的弧度，润泽而饱满。

Pip: The flowers?!
阿措：杏花……?!

A strangeness unlike anything that has come before. Never have there been so many flowers at once.
从来没有过这样离奇的事，从来没有过这样多的花。

It's as if all the apricot flowers of the last two hundred years have come into bloom at once.
仿佛过去两百年里的杏花都在同一刻盛开，仿佛两百多个春天同时来临。

Under the tree, Paper Heron rests her hand against the tree's gnarled trunk. Her white jade sword is drawn in her other hand, its white Qi wrapping around her.
杏花树下，鹭鸶剪抚摸着虬结的树干。她随身带着的白玉长剑不知何时出了鞘，莹莹的剑气在周身缠绕。

Pip: What-What is this?
阿措：这……这是怎么回事……

Paper Heron: Hmm. This tree has good fortune.
鹭鸶剪：唔，这可是棵交了好运的杏花树。

Paper Heron: Its Qi wasn't fully cut off, see. Once the flow cleared, all the life stored over the years burst forth.
鹭鸶剪：它的气蕴没完全断绝，气脉一旦畅通，这些年积攒的生机就会迸发出来。

Paper Heron gazes up at the tree full of flowers, her expression hidden.
鹭鸶剪抬头仰望一树杏花，阿措看不见她的表情。

Paper Heron: It's beautiful.
鹭鸶剪：真漂亮啊。

Pip: You found a way to fix it!
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你想到修补的法子了！

Paper Heron: No. Not exactly.
鹭鸶剪：没有。

Paper Heron: I destroyed the old enchantment.
鹭鸶剪：不过，我把原先的法阵毁了。

Pip: You did? Why didn't I think of something so simple?
阿措：把原先的法阵毁了……原来还有这个办法。我怎么没想到?

Pip: No, I couldn't even see how the Qi flowed. Even if the idea had struck me, I wouldn't have known where to start. Heron, you're amazing!
阿措：不，我连其中的气如何运转都看不明白，就算想到了，也不知要怎么做……鹭鸶剪，你好厉害！

Paper Heron: You shouldn't doubt yourself. Like I said, the enchantment wasn't complex.
鹭鸶剪：未必做不到。我不是说了嘛，这阵法不难。

Paper Heron: It's just this may have been the last thing she left in this world.
鹭鸶剪：只是，这可能是我师姐在世上留下的最后一样东西了。

Pip: The last thing she left?
阿措：——你师姐留下的，最后一样东西?

She blankly parrots the words, her voice absent of their original meaning.
阿措愣愣地重复。

Paper Heron: Yes. This was my senior sister's work.
鹭鸶剪：嗯，的确是她的手笔。

Pip: And you just destroyed it?
阿措：那，你、你就这么把它……毁了?

Paper Heron: The enchantment needed mending, reweaving, every two hundred years. But there's no one left who knows how.
鹭鸶剪：这阵法须每两百年加固一次，可如今世上已经没有知晓加固之法的人。

Paper Heron: Even if we'd kept it, it would have faded over time.
鹭鸶剪：哪怕勉强留它在此，再过些年也自会消散。

Paper Heron: You needn't worry. I used my school's sword to set the Qi flow right again.
鹭鸶剪：你放心，我已用宗门法剑重新梳理了气脉。

Paper Heron: Even without anyone to tend it, there should be no more trouble.
鹭鸶剪：以后就算无人疏导，也不会出事了。

Pip: You mean the Qi here will never stagnate again?
阿措：你是说，从此这里的气脉再不会凝滞?

Paper Heron: Exactly.
鹭鸶剪：正是。

Pip: ...
阿措：……

Pip: And is the old enchantment gone forever? No trace remains?
阿措：那，原先的法阵，也就此消失，一点痕迹都不会留下吗……

Petals drift down, landing on Pip's hair and shoulders and in Paper Heron's open hand.
花瓣纷纷扬扬，落在阿措的头发上、肩膀上，也落在鹭鸶剪摊开的手心里。

Paper Heron: Yes. Nothing remains.
鹭鸶剪：是啊，什么都不会留下。

【3.4】鹭鸶剪玩法 08

COL-314110

Elder: Look! The flowers! They're really blooming!
老丈：——花开了，花真的开了！

Elder: This calls for a celebration! I'll head into town and buy some wine for us, the real good stuff! You just wait right here!
老丈：我这就去镇上打二两好酒，你们等我回来！

Pip: What? Wait! Please, there's no need to go to all that trouble.
阿措：哎，哎——老丈！老丈！不用破费了！

Pip: He waited all this time for it to bloom, only to take off the moment it does. Can you believe it?
阿措：等了这么多年的杏花，老丈才看了两眼，怎么就走了?

Paper Heron: So what? We have nothing but time ahead.
鹭鸶剪：这有什么，未来的时间还很长嘛。

Pip: Really? But ...
阿措：未来的时间？可是……

Pip lowers her voice to just above a whisper.
阿措的声音低了下去。

Pip: But he's nearly 80 years old.
阿措：可是老丈已经年近八旬了……

Paper Heron: Hmm? Did you say something?
鹭鸶剪：嗯？什么?

Pip: Nothing, never mind. I think the sun will set soon.
阿措：没什么，我是说，太阳快要下山了。

Paper Heron: You're right. We should rest while it's still shining.
鹭鸶剪：趁着日头还在，休息休息吧。

Paper Heron stretches out on the revivified grass, and Pip takes a seat beside her.
她顺势懒洋洋地躺倒在嫩绿的草地上，阿措也在她身边坐下。

Pip: Where will you go after this?
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你之后打算去哪里?

Paper Heron: I'm not sure. I've left matters in Huanzhou with a friend, so perhaps it's time I explored somewhere new.
鹭鸶剪：不知道，四处游历吧。涣州的事我已经托付给朋友，也是时候去别处看看了。

Paper Heron: And you?
鹭鸶剪：你呢，阿措？

Pip: Maybe I'll go home. I still have a lot to learn.
阿措：或许回家一趟？我要学的还有很多。

Pip: Actually, I slipped away without telling anyone.
阿措：其实……我是偷偷跑出来的。

Paper Heron: I suspected as much. You're too young to be out here alone. Your family must be worried about you.
鹭鸶剪：我就说嘛。你才多大，家中长辈定然是不放心的。

Soft blades of grass press against Paper Heron's fingertips, a sign that they're still growing.
她随意拨弄着新长出的小草，草叶轻轻顶着她的指尖，仿佛还在继续生长。

Pip: I have another question.
阿措：鹭鸶剪，我还有个问题。

Paper Heron: Go ahead.
鹭鸶剪：嗯，你问。

Pip: Have you lived a long time?
阿措：你……是不是活了很久？

Pip: The things you mentioned on the way here, the East Port being busy once—they're all from the past.
阿措：你一路上提到的那些风物，都是过去的事了。

Pip: And the story of the immortal in Huanzhou dates back nearly two hundred years.
阿措：涣州有仙人祛灾的传闻，也是近两百年前……

Pip: ...
阿措：……

Pip: I'm sorry. It's alright if you don't want to talk about it. Just forget I asked.
阿措：抱歉，如果不方便，你就当我没问吧。

The wind brushes against Paper Heron's hair.
风吹起鹭鸶剪鬓角的头发。

Paper Heron: That's quite alright. Yes, it's true. Not much gets past you.
鹭鸶剪：没什么不方便的，确实如此。你好聪明！

Paper Heron: But I didn't intend to. It's hard to explain. Just think of me like the old man's tree. I, too, have suffered a long illness.
鹭鸶剪：不过这并非我的本意……说来有点复杂，你就当我和老丈的那棵杏花树一样，是生了一场大病吧。

Pip: What does it feel like to live for so long?
阿措：那……活了这么久，是什么感觉？

Paper Heron: Hmm. Well ...
鹭鸶剪：我想想啊……

Paper Heron: It doesn't feel so special. When you're ill for a long time, you almost forget what it's like to be well.
鹭鸶剪：没什么特别的感觉。生病久了，也就觉不出自己在病中了。

Pip: Why call it an illness? Many people dream of living long lives. Even in stories, that's what the Daoists sought.
阿措：为什么说是生病呢？多少人做梦都想长生。哪怕话本小说里，修道之人所求也不外乎此……

Paper Heron: You shouldn't believe everything you read in stories!
鹭鸶剪：你也知道那是话本啊！

Paper Heron: And from what books, pray tell, did you find this information?
鹭鸶剪：咳咳……你读的都是什么本子？

Pip: *Legend of the Getian*, *The White Horse Immortal: A Tale of Medicine*, and *Three Years of Strange Dreams: A Collection*.
阿措：《葛天氏外传》《白马真人悬壶记》，还有《三秋梦录平话》……

Paper Heron: So *Legend of the Getian* is still popular, even after two hundred years, eh? I remember a story about a mortal seeking the Way from the Getian clan. He descends the mountain, only to discover that a thousand years have passed.
鹭鸶剪：看来两百年过去，《葛天氏外传》卖得依旧很好嘛。我记得里面有个凡人向葛天氏求道，下山后发现人间已经过了千年的故事，是不是？

Paper Heron: Those stories talk of immortals desiring the mortal world or mortals yearning for the immortal realm. At their core, they describe what one cannot attain.
鹭鸶剪：那些受人欢迎的长生故事，或是仙人眷红尘，或是凡客慕玉京，说到底，讲的都是有所不能。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron: My senior sister once said that, as a person ages, time seems to speed up.
鹭鸶剪：从前师姐和我说，随着人的年岁渐长，时间的流动也会越来越快。

Paper Heron: I didn't argue then, but deep down, I disagreed.
鹭鸶剪：我当时没有反驳，但心里很不以为然。

Paper Heron: When you're young, the blooming and fading of flowers marks a season. That time doesn't change, even decades later. Flowers still bloom. Seasons still pass. Everything feels just as it did.
鹭鸶剪：十多岁的时候，花开花落是为一季；等到十几年后、几十年后，一季的时间，不也同样是从花开等到花谢吗？

Paper Heron: But now, I see she was right.
鹭鸶剪：但现在看来，她说得对。

Paper Heron: The first ten years feel slow. But the next ten are easier to endure.
鹭鸶剪：第一个十年，一切都过得好慢……但第二个十年就没那么难熬了。

Paper Heron: After that, the days just pass, one after another.
鹭鸶剪：再往后……日子总会慢慢过去的。

Pip gazes at the sky.
阿措望着天空。

Pip: I ... I don't quite understand.
阿措：嗯……我不太懂。

Pip: I'll be seventeen soon, so for me, this is the seventeenth spring.
阿措：我马上就十七岁了，这是我见过的第十七个春天。

Pip: Paper Heron, how many springs have you seen?
阿措：鹭鸶剪，你见过多少个春天呢？

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

Paper Heron: I don't remember. You certainly ask tricky questions.
鹭鸶剪：这我可记不清，你的问题好难啊。

Mule: Bray—
骡子：咴——

Not far away, the mule lifts its head, braying and running off as if it spots something.
不远处，原本低头吃草的骡子不知看到了什么，忽地长嘶一声，向远处跑去。

Pip: I'll go get it!
阿措：我去把它追回来！

Paper Heron: No need to rush, eh? It won't get far.
鹭鸶剪：无妨，它跑得不快，慢些跟上去也来得及。

Pip: But ...
阿措：可是……

Paper Heron: It likely knows this area better than us. It'll come back if it wishes it.
鹭鸶剪：何况它既然认路，或许过一会儿就自己回来了。

Pip: No, I made a promise. I have to keep it.
阿措：不成，我答应的事就一定要做到。

Paper Heron: What promise?
鹭鸶剪：嗯？你答应什么了？

Pip: When we met today, I said I would help you anytime you needed it.
阿措：今日初见时我说，倘若有什么能帮上你的，义不容辞。

Pip: I wasn't sure how and when I would give it, but, at the very least, I can fetch your mule.
阿措：当时我想不到能做什么……不过，把你的骡子找回来还是可以的。

Paper Heron: My mule?
鹭鸶剪：我的骡子？

She looks up, surprised, propping herself on her elbow to better see Pip.
她略微有些吃惊，支起胳膊看着年轻的修道者。

Pip: Yes! The mule should go to the one who fixed the Qi flow, no, to the one who saved the tree.
阿措：对啊！这骡子该送给解决气凝之事……不，是救活了杏花树的人。

Pip: So it belongs to you now!
阿措：所以，它现在是你的骡子了！

Paper Heron: Well, I suppose it'll give me a companion on my travels.
鹭鸶剪：也好，那我游历时也算是有个同行的朋友了。

Pip: He's a slow thing, but it's not as though you're in a hurry.
阿措：这骡子虽然走不快，但好在你也不赶时间嘛。

The sound of the mule's steps grows quieter with each passing second.
说话间，骡子的声音越来越远。

Pip: I should go check on it. You stay here, alright? I'll be right back.
阿措：我得去看看，你就在这儿等着我，好不好？我马上就回来！

Paper Heron: Sure. You'd better be quick.
鹭鸶剪：好啊，那你可要快些。

Paper Heron lays her head back down.
鹭鸶剪重新躺下。

The rustling of the grass quiets, and the rays of sunlight feel warm on her skin. It's not long before she closes her eyes and drifts off to sleep.
草叶摇晃声渐渐远去。阳光确乎极好，她闭上眼睛，有些困倦。

Paper Heron: Seventeen ...
鹭鸶剪：十七岁……

Paper Heron: The year I went down the mountain with Finch, I was seventeen then too, I think.
鹭鸶剪：我跟着师姐下山那年，也是十七岁吧。

Paper Heron: ...
鹭鸶剪：……

A soft rustle from the bush rouses her attention.
道人耳畔响起一阵莎莎声。

Mule: Bray.
骡子：——咴。

Paper Heron: Hmm? You're back? Where's Pip?
鹭鸶剪：嗯？你怎么回来了？只有你吗？

She pats the mule's neck affectionately.
她伸手戳了戳骡子。

The mule ignores her instead, shaking its ears and walking over to the tree to munch on the new grass.
骡子不理不睬，抖了抖耳朵，自顾自行到树下啃食新草。

Paper Heron: Good timing. You can help me think ...
鹭鸶剪：正好，你也来帮我想想……

Paper Heron: How many springs have I seen?
鹭鸶剪：究竟是多少个春天呢？

...
……

How many springs have I seen?
究竟是多少个春天呢？

The same spring breeze blows, the same vitalized grass sways, and the mule gives no answer.
春风吹拂，春草摇曳，骡子也不知道答案。

Is it two hundred springs?
两百个春天吗？

Twenty?
二十多个春天吗？

One?
一个春天吗？

...
……

Or has she lost all her springs?
还是说，她已经失去了所有的春天？

Pearl Finch: Master, I thought long and hard on the matter yesterday. Please don't be too harsh with her.
师姐：师父，我昨日想了很久……您还是不要对她过于严苛。

Pearl Finch: We will all leave one day.
师姐：我们总会离开。

Pearl Finch: And when she does, she will walk a long, lonely road.
师姐：在此之后，她还要一个人走很远。

Pearl Finch: ...
师姐：……

Pearl Finch: Don't make her loneliness any heavier to bear.
师姐：她或许会很孤独的。